

FIRST NIGHT

DOMINATED BY THEIR LANDLORD



KT MORRISON

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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All characters are over the age of eighteen.

FIRST NIGHT

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Written by KT Morrison

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CHAPTER ONE

JONNY HELD the expensive shoe in his hands, standing in the late afternoon sunshine falling in from the windows that looked out over the city. The shoes their landlord bought his wife. So expensive Jonny thought he'd been lying. Looked them up, saw he wasn't.

The foot that would slip in this shoe was perfection. Petite and narrow, elegantly formed with a sweeping arch and the prettiest toes he'd ever seen. Imagined that foot slipping in the expensive crystal-studded leather, remembering what it looked like when she'd twirled in the kitchen for him and Reza.

She'd been stunning. Her beauty revealed. No longer the bookish farm girl, Reza had let the woman inside her blossom like an orchid, her petals unfurled (in more ways than one), opening and filling the air of the apartment, now redolent with the sweet smell of her charms ... then that flower plunged through with their landlord's garish cock.

It was an ugly thought. But it was true, Charlie was changing. That night on the town with their swarthy master affected her. She'd admitted to Jonny her desires. She had fun with another man. And that man had the funds and the ability to show her the good time Jonny never could. It drove a stake through him. Worse was the dark slippery pleasure he also received.

Watching her with another man, and even on the first of this month when he'd only been retold afterward. But told the worst details ...

Jonny, I asked him to please fuck me ...

She asked for it. This time she'd fucking asked for it. It crushed him like a medieval torture device, screws turning, pressing the weight, more stones added. And yet the whole time he was erect. The weight pressed against the belly of his cock and it just felt so damn good even though he knew it would eventually kill him. It was crazy. If he loved her so much and valued her so much what excited him about seeing her violated by such a brute?

He went back to the closet—the door left open, the light turned on, the shoe's twin angled on the shelf. Charlie put them in there the last time. He watched her arrange them; heels to the back, toes angled toward the door. She'd been drinking, and she wanted to admire them. Was revealing to him that she loved the gift of those shoes. No one ever bought his wife a gift like that. Especially not Jonny. Not even when he had money though he did splurge on her. Books, and trips, and dinners out. He loved her. But the dress and shoes Reza bought were what a *man* gave a woman.

And boy did Reza know women. Jonny's Charlie was a shy and demure wife—raised on a farm, home-schooled, now a librarian—he'd never an inkling she would adore such feminine things. But given those gifts, she gasped and squealed like a little girl on Christmas morning.

There was evidence now, too, she'd still been enamored with (at least) the shoes. The sperm-stained dress still hung in the closet, just the way Jonny put it there. It should be dry-cleaned before she ever wore it again, a big yogurt dollop on the skirt and the underside splattered with Reza's sexual product.

But the shoes had been moved.

And Jonny figured his wife had been admiring them again. His wife who'd never acted as though she liked shoes, unlike every other girl he ever met, did actually *like* shoes.

He could picture her, trying them on and seeing what they looked like again. Considering Jonny was always at home, he must've been here. Pictured Charlie then slipping into her closet maybe bundling up the shoes in a towel, bringing them into the bathroom and closing herself in. What would she do then? Slip those perfect feet in them, twist her ankles around and admire them. Then she would stand, watch her reflection in the mirror, flex her calves. Would she be naked? He pictured it. And while she did this solo fashion show, did she recall that evening with Reza? Did she recall the last time she wore them, these goddamn beautiful shoes, she'd had them bobbing over Reza's back while he fucked her?

That horrible thought began a swelling in his shorts. This was a common reaction now, and he hated it. Hated it but somehow was still playing with it. Still exploring its poisonous blade.

He set the shoes together side-by-side and turned them to face the way she left them when he'd witnessed her put them in there. A signal he was on to her. Let her know he knew what she was up to. His bad girl. Never once in his life had she ever seemed like a bad girl but their musclebound Iraqi landlord was definitely making her one.

The arrangement, when initiated, was so difficult, awkward, and uncomfortable. One could never anticipate the two of them would find themselves like this; his wife beginning to enjoy her time with the man she once feared.

The way this whole thing began, one could never have predicted the situation he would find himself in now.

5 months ago ...

CHAPTER TWO

“JONNY, I can’t. I changed my mind, Jonny, I can’t do it ...”

“It’s too late now, Charlie. It’s too late.”

“Why? No, it’s not, Jonny.”

“It is, Charlie. What you did ... already ... You did that for nothing?”

“He wants more, Jonny. I can’t give him more. I don’t even want to use my mouth on him again. How can I—”

“Don’t, Charlie, don’t think about it.”

Her nails dug deeply into his forearms. He held the insides of her elbows, pinning her to the wall. Not out of anger, but with enormous love. She was panicking. On the verge of a full-blown panic attack. He’d offered her a Benadryl to calm her down, but she refused.

“Charlie, he’s going to be here soon.”

Instead of getting her focused that statement frightened her even more. Her mouth twisted into a down-turned bow, her lips began to wriggle and her face went red. Tears swelled in her eyes and she cried, “Tell him not to come, Jonny, please, please, just call him, tell him we’ll figure something out.”

He gripped her tightly, said, “Charlie, come on. We told him we would do this.”

“We told him I would do this—I’m the one doing this ...”

“I know, baby, I know, and I love you for it.”

“How can I do it? How Jonny? How can you ever look at me again?”

“I don’t care, Charlie, I really don’t. If you don’t want to do it, I understand. But, baby, we’ve already come so far. We’ll be on the tracks again soon, I swear.”

“I can’t, Jonny. Have him inside me? Oh, please ...”

“I know, baby, I know. I know it’s going to be so hard. But it will be over quick, and then we can stay here. Remember? You want to stay here, don’t you?”

“I know, I do, Jonny, I really do. I said I would, but now he’s coming I just can’t.”

He hugged her, stopped the hold on her elbows and took her in his arms and squeezed her. “Baby, I’m going to be right here with you. I’m gonna be with you the whole time, nothing bad is going to happen. Okay?”

She whispered into his neck, “I can’t ... I can’t ... I can’t ...”

“You can, baby, you can.” He soothed her, his hands going in circles around her slender back. Her body weight slumped against him and he knew that she would do it.

What else would they do? Go back to Kansas? Back to that religious compound? And how would they do that? How would Jonny go to her parents and show them how he didn’t deserve their daughter? How would they ever survive that? Being taken by Reza was survivable. The shame of his failure exposed to her stern parents wasn’t. Charlie knew it too. Charlie knew what it would mean. That shame, her husband’s shame, would fall on her as well. She was the one who married this guy. He had a feeling they warned her. She didn’t listen, Jonny’s charms were strong.

They stood in the kitchen, her back pressed to the wall across from the sink, him holding her while she breathed against him heavily.

“There, there,” he said again, calming her. “You’re okay. It will all be okay, I swear.”

“Okay,” she whispered.

“Okay?”

Now he felt her nodding, her dainty little chin tapping his collar.

“How?”

“How what, baby?”

“How do I do this?” she said solemnly.

“We’ll take it one step at a time. I won’t let him hurt you.”

She made a little gasp, darted her face back. “You think he might hurt me?”

“You know—what you said ...”

“Oh,” she said, her eyes turning downward. “His size.”

“Or whatever, Charlie. I’ll make sure you’re okay.”

“You have to stay here, Jonny, you have to.”

“I will,” he agreed. “I definitely will.”

“If he says you have to go, then I can’t do it.”

“Don’t worry, baby, I’ll be here.”

She said, “It has to be here, in the apartment.”

He said, “I know. I think that’s what he wants, too.”

“I mean it, Jonny. He said something about a date ...”

“That was just allegory, Charlie.”

“Can we have any rules?”

“Rules like what?”

“I don’t know ... Like things he can’t do.”

“Is there something you don’t want to do?”

She whispered, “I don’t want to put my mouth on it again.”

“You don’t?”

She shook her head no. “And I don’t like ... You know ...”

“What, Charlie?”

“You know, Jonny ... From behind.”

“Charlie,” Jonny said, “you don’t want him to have anal sex with you?”

“Oh, no, no way, Jonny. I don’t like it when *you* do it.”

“You don’t like it when I do it?” he said, giving her a little smirk, trying to brighten her by sounding offended.

“It hurts,” she whispered, and she wrinkled her nose, added, “It feels weird.”

Jonny said, “We can tell him.”

“*You* tell him.”

“You don’t want to talk to him?”

“Jonny, I just want to do it and get him out of here. And then after I don’t want to talk about it, okay?”

“Not at all?”

She sighed, said, “No way, Jonny. Not at all. Like *not* at all. Okay?”

Jonny said, “You’re very brave.”

“Oh, please,” she sighed.

“I mean it, Charlie. You’re the bravest girl I know.”

“I’m a real hero,” she sighed, and laid her cheek on his chest.

“You are to me.”

“That’s very nice to say, Jonny.”

“Do you feel better now?”

“A little,” she said. “I don’t think I’m going to have a heart attack just yet, anyway.”

He eased her back, rubbed her shoulders with his palms, smiled at her, then kissed her T-shirt between her breasts right over her heart. He said, “I love your little heart.”

Her eyes welled like she would cry, and she put her cupped palm over the spot where he just kissed her. “I love you, baby,” she said.

“I love you so much, Charlie. We can get through this.”

WHEN THE KNOCK finally came on the door, they both jumped.

They'd left their bed pulled out, and Jonny had made it up with fresh bedding while Charlie was closed in the bathroom for half an hour. They sat facing the television side-by-side in their matching red Ikea chairs, upright and stiff, hands clenched over the curved noses of the padded armrests. There was a movie on and he bet that neither of them could tell the other the plot line. The knock on the door brought Charlie half out of the chair, her thighs slapping together. She wore a sweatshirt and sweatpants and bare feet. It was almost dinnertime, and they both had wondered whether Reza would show at all. Maybe it was all a ruse, some sort of joke. Something he wouldn't actually make her go through with. Of course that was crazy, given what he had allowed last month at their kitchen table. He'd come through, too. Given them the money for Charlie's 'audition.'

In the quiet after the knock, Charlie whispered, "Can you get it, Jonny?"

"Yeah," he said, rubbing his hands together. His palms were sweaty. He rose, walked slowly. Before he made it to the door a louder knock came, indicating someone's impatience. That was a sure sign that it was Reza. It was Reza, and this was really going to happen. He went up the two steps, into the kitchen, slid the chain lock, turned the bolt and opened the door.

Reza was waiting in the hall. Not leering, not anxious, not smiling. Confident, menacing. He stood with his hands in his pockets, his grim face emotionless, his mouth hidden by his thick beard and heavy mustache.

"I thought you might be too afraid to answer," he said in a low and gravelly voice.

"No," he said. "We were waiting."

"That's good," he said, and he walked past Jonny and into the kitchen. His head turned, looking over the kitchen and down into the family room. When he saw what he was looking for he smiled. "Hi, Charlie. There you are. It's been a long month and I've been looking forward to this."

Charlie sat still facing the TV, her side to them. She turned and half-regarded them both and nodded solemnly.

“That’s a girl,” he said, shrugging out of his coat. He handed it to Jonny.

He didn’t know what to do with it, draped it over the back of the kitchen chair and watched as Reza stepped down into their family room. He followed behind.

Hands still in his pockets, Reza stood in the late afternoon sunlight beaming in the window, squinting and regarding the city for a moment, then looking down and studying the bed that Jonny had made for him to fuck his wife on. Jonny saw that he nodded slightly.

He turned then and extended a hand out to Charlie and she looked at it, chewing her lower lip. “Charlie,” he urged now, indicating to take his hand by wagging it.

She looked up to Reza, her eyes wide and wet, and said, “Right away?”

“Are you frightened?” he said.

She nodded, her chin dimpling and her mouth turning down.

“Don’t be. Come,” he said, wagging his hand again.

Now she extended both of hers, and he took one, pulled her to stand before him.

“You are a beauty.”

“Don’t ...”

“You’re the first woman I’ve ever met who didn’t want a compliment. Believe me, Charlie, I’m only stating facts. Turn around for me.”

Her eyes darted to Jonny, and she said to him, “Do I have to?”

“Turn around for me, Charlie. I want to look at you.”

Charlie complied, crossing her arms in front of her, one hand gripping the other wrist and lowering her eyes. She turned in place and faced out the window away from both of them. Reza put her hands on her and Jonny’s heart jumped.

His hands went on her shoulders, smoothed down the outside of her arms then down to her waist. Charlie jerked a little as if she wanted to get out of his reach but was forcing herself to stay. He squeezed her waist, felt

how narrow she was, hands slipping over the crest of her buttocks, then rotating his fingers face down and cupping them. He squeezed her ass, and she stepped away.

“Charlie ...” he warned.

“Sorry,” she whispered without turning around.

Reza stepped forward and his hands went to her waist again, this time slipping under her waistband and easing the sweatpants down so he could see her skin and the black cotton of her panties. With his thumbs, he guided the pants lower, past the V of the panties and revealing the bare outer curve of her cheeks. Charlie was flinching again.

Reza leaned close to her and whispered, “You have a beautiful ass.”

“Thank you,” she whispered.

He lowered the sweatpants so that her entire ass and the back of her thighs were revealed.

“Jonny, Jonny, you are one lucky man. I don’t think Charlie knows how lucky you are.”

“I’m the one that’s lucky,” Charlie whispered.

“Ah. The loyal wife,” he mocked.

CHARLIE SAID, “Don’t be mean to me.”

“Mean to you? What would make you think I would be mean?”

Even him saying that, incredulous at implied meanness, was irony. It dripped with menace even the way he questioned her. He was a big guy, thickly built with a dense black beard, oily black hair, dark and foreboding eyes. And he had power over them.

Jonny ventured, “I just don’t think she wants to be hurt.”

“I wouldn’t hurt her,” he said and then ran the backs of his fingers up her cheek and Charlie closed her eyes. “I’m going to be very good to Charlie. Charlie is going to remember this for a long time.”

Charlie said, "Can we just do it?"

Reza sneered, said, "Someone is in a hurry. I like to take my time but I understand your anticipation. Lift up your arms."

The last vestiges of Charlie's strength held hold for a few heartbeats while their eyes met. She would defy him, but only until she didn't. They all knew what was going to happen, her resistance was a show. She sucked that lower lip into her mouth again, slowly raised her hands up above her head. Her sweatshirt came up and they could see her black panties and her pale tummy.

Reza put the flat palm of his enormous hand on her belly under her T-shirt and he hummed with admiration. "You have the finest, most graceful body."

His hand eased northward, raising up the sweatshirt, getting to her bra, the other hand joining in. Took the hem of her sweatshirt in both his hands then, and raised them up her outstretched arms, her hair falling out in a beautiful ginger fan winking in the sunlight. He threw the sweatshirt aside. Now Charlie stood before him in only a bra and her panties, her sweatpants pulled down to the tops of her thighs.

Reza circled his arms around her, meeting them in the back and working on the hitch of her bra. Charlie closed her eyes and turned up her nose, pulled her face away, not liking him so close. "That's it," he said as the bra sagged with release. He ran his fingers over her shoulders and the bra fell free and down to the floor. Charlie didn't cover up. Stood there, trembling, her beautiful little breasts completely bared for this frightening man. Her nipples condensed.

"Hmm," he hummed and took one of his big fingers, ran it over her ribs and up the underside of a breast to touch the point of a nipple. "You're even more beautiful than I imagined," he said. "Your pants now."

"Okay," she said quietly. Her eyes darted to Jonny, and she thumbed inside the sweatpants and pushed them down far enough that they fell to the

floor, pulled her feet out of them, turning them inside out, then swiping them away by stepping on each leg and pulling her foot free.

“Wow, wow, wow,” Reza exhaled. His eyes went over her with serious admiration. He stepped back to get a better look and Charlie wilted in his gaze. He walked around her in a circle, his head swiveling as he went. He unbuttoned his collared shirt, going around three times until it was undone and hanging open. He stopped in front of her, opened the shirt, arched his back and Jonny could see the muscle he had.

He was very thickly furred, coarse black matted hair over big hard plates of muscle. He peeled the shirt off and tossed it so it lay over one of the red chairs. He was shirtless now, showing off his impressive body. Jonny watched Charlie’s eyes as they went up and down and over this other man. There was a tattoo on his neck that you could see even when he was dressed. It looked like the face of a roaring lion. He could see the rest of it now, a lion and scimitars from his neck down over his shoulder. On his side there was a drawing of what looked like a medieval warrior with a big twisted mustache, holding an enormous broadsword planted in the ground between his feet. Behind the soldier, Jonny could see medieval forts and fortresses, and smoke and horses. It was very intricate, which was strange because it was greatly hidden by hair. His shoulders were big and broad and very round. He wasn’t short, but so thickly built that he appeared stocky.

Charlie’s eyes still lingered. Reza’s hands fell to his belt buckle. Something alligator with a bright shining clasp he unhooked with the flip of a lever. Undid his pants button, slowly pulled down his zipper. Pants opened, he spread the fly and eased them down his hips where they fell to the floor. He wore no underwear and that ghastly tool dangled looking like a dark elephant’s trunk. He wore slip on loafers and he peeled them off with his toes and stepped out of them and the pants. Not wearing socks, their landlord now stood completely naked in front of Jonny’s wife. Jonny had

turned to steel inside his underwear. Was grateful to have his shirt untucked right now.

Reza, the man who in a few minutes would have sex with his wife, on the other hand, hung limp and heavy between his thighs. Jonny noticed that Charlie watched Reza's big uncircumcised thing, watched it sway and saw that she squinted and had her little nose turned up. Her hands clasped together at her crotch worked and twisted, fingers writhing into one another with nerves. Reza smiled, noticing Jonny's wife's gaze lingering on his gnarly, yet glorious manhood. He said, "Now you."

Charlie's eyes came up to Reza's, she said, "Me what?"

Reza bit his lower lip, a smile pulling up high on one side, a flash of white teeth under his thick mustache. He said, "It's your turn. I want to see you ..."

"Okay," she said shakily. She lowered her gaze, demurely averting her eyes for Reza as she revealed herself. Slipping her hands into her panties and sliding them down her hips until they fell to the floor. She stood, but cupped her hands between her legs, hiding her mound.

Reza leaned forward, nudged her hands away with the first knuckle of the big hand, smiling quite wide. "Let's see," he whispered, "let's see."

Charlie revealed herself, her hands turning to fists, her thumb tucked under her fingers, arms thrust straight down at her sides, chewing the inside of her mouth and looking at the ceiling. Reza looked between her legs, saw the ginger patch of hair that covered her there.

"Your skin is beautiful, Charlie. Your hair is exquisite."

Jonny saw her skin turn to goose flesh.

"Okay," she whispered, a hint of impatience in her voice.

"Shall we?" he said, gesturing toward their bed with an outstretched hand.

Charlie shook visibly. Reluctance revealed in shaking hands, tremors that went through her body suddenly. "Oh-okay," she said, her breaths

coming rapidly like she was once more on the verge of panic.

Reza walked to her side, rested his hand on the small of her back and stepped her toward the bed, stopping at its side. "You made your bed for me," he said, looking in her eyes. She stared back, lips trembling, then said, "Jonny made the bed."

Without looking over, Reza said, "Thank you, Jonny. That's very thoughtful. Now, Charlie, give me your hand."

"Why?" she said.

"I want to see your hand."

"Okay," she said, and bent her arm at the elbow, presented it to him palm up, still held close to her body.

"That's it," he said. "That beautiful hand."

He admired it for a moment, taking it in his own, running a thumb over her palm. Then he eased it lower and Charlie resisted, but still he guided it lower. He held it at his hip, then with his other hand, took his big penis and dropped it in her palm. Charlie's face twisted up with disgust. She closed her eyes and her mouth worked from side to side. "You know what to do," he whispered.

CHAPTER THREE

“I CAN’T ... I can’t do that again,” she whimpered.

“Jonny,” Reza said, still watching Charlie.

Jonny had been standing, his back now fallen against the family room wall next to the foot of the stairs to the kitchen. He was weak in the knees, but he hefted himself away from the wall and took a step into the room, he said, “Reza ... She doesn’t want to do that. Doesn’t want to use her mouth again. She doesn’t want that, and she doesn’t want—”

“Go on,” Reza said, still staring at Charlie whose eyes were open now but turned to the ceiling. She held that big wrinkled thing, filling up her hand, folds of skin squeezing between her fingers. The puckered end of it dangled over her index finger.

Jonny continued, “Reza ... She doesn’t want it, you know, from behind in her—”

Reza said, “Well that leaves one thing. It’s the thing that I came for.”

With that, Reza touched her between her legs. Charlie jumped backward, lifting her feet up off the floor one at a time, fell on the bed onto her rump, her breasts shaking.

She said, “Oh no, oh please, don’t ...”

Reza smiled, and he put a knee on the bed, following after her. Jonny could see that his penis had grown, that sagging thing getting longer,

coming to life. It dangled between his legs; it looked like halfway down his thighs.

Charlie watched it swing, her brows pulled up high and frightened. Reza said, “You don’t have to do anything you don’t want to, Charlie. I liked what you did last month. You know what I’m here for now ...”

Jonny said, “Reza, we haven’t talked about that. Haven’t talked about the deal ...”

“You know the deal. One month rent.”

“Yeah, but last time she used her mouth. Now you want something ... more ...”

“Yes?” His eyes stayed on Charlie the whole time.

Jonny said, “Isn’t *it* worth more?”

Reza got his other knee on the bed now and Charlie backed herself up to the pillows. Reza walked himself closer to her.

“Jonny,” Reza said without looking over, eyes boring between Charlie’s legs that she’d clamped together but drawn up, pink sex visible from behind. “I’m not paying you for what I get from Charlie. You’re compensated for *my* time. Not Charlie’s. For fifteen minutes that you have me ... now you know what it’s worth ...”

Charlie said, “So if I ... maybe if I just use my mouth again ...?”

“I thought you didn’t want that?” He smiled, and before she could answer, he said, “It doesn’t matter, anyway. My time is valuable, I know what I’m here for. It’s not your mouth. Not this time.”

“Okay, okay,” she said, then sheepishly added: “Did you bring a condom?”

“I don’t wear condoms,” he grinned.

The expression on her face twisted in sorrow, her shoulders slumping, eyes rolling as if she’d expected that answer.

Jonny’s heart raced and despite the most present thoughts leaping out at him and spreading their arms in disallowance, his mouth opened then

closed ... and he said nothing.

Reza said, "Aren't you on the pill?"

She shook her head no, brow raised fearfully.

Reza chuckled, eyes lasciviously narrowing on her exposed sex. "Now *this* is exciting."

Reza got closer, extended a hand and draped it over one of her pale thin knees. He eased it to the side and Charlie's other leg followed, keeping her sex closed. With his other hand, he held the opposite knee now, eased them apart. Charlie whimpered again, looking to the ceiling, her hands curled into weak fists that she clutched at her stomach.

Reza said, "You're just perfect everywhere, aren't you, Charlie? That sweet pink slit is as perfect as your beautiful face."

He ran the back of his hairy hand between her legs, over her exposed flaps. Charlie's tummy trembled visibly, fluttering, her nipples hardened, but she made a low moaning sound, then she closed her legs fast, pinching Reza's hand in between them.

"No," she said, "I can't. I just can't ..."

She fell to her side, but now she was face to face with that dangling monster. When she regarded it, saw how close it was to her mouth, she reeled back, clawing herself along the pillows to the far side of the bed, getting her feet on the floor then trotted to the bathroom and slammed herself in there.

REZA LAUGHED, still on his knees watching the closed door. He turned and set himself on the bed, leaned back on the pillows. He held his cock in his hand and idly stroked it. It was gaining rigidity, not flopping, but his foreskin still bunched over the glans. He said, "Jonny, find out if she's okay. But tell her she got two minutes. I gotta go. If she doesn't want to do this,

that's fine. Believe me, she's beautiful, but she's not the only one in the city that I can fuck."

Jonny said, "Okay, she's just a little worried is all."

"Two minutes, Jonny," he said, and though he was otherwise naked, he still wore a shining gold watch that he now regarded.

"Okay, yeah," Jonny said, then made his way to the bathroom door. He tapped with the point of his index finger, whispered, "Charlie? ..."

There was no answer. He did it again, tapping the point of his finger louder. "Charlie? ..."

There was a pause, then a quiet: "What?"

"Can I come in?"

"Yeah," she said.

Jonny nodded to Reza, opened the door and slipped into the bathroom, closing it behind him without making a sound. Charlie sat on the lip of the tub, her elbows on her knees, her hands over her face, and her hair hanging down over her legs, hiding her. He went to her, lay his butt on the tile floor and stroked her calf. "You okay?"

"No," she said.

"You're not going to do it?"

"I don't know, Jonny."

"You don't have to. I don't know what we'll do but we'll survive."

She whispered, "I'll do it."

"You will?"

"Just give me a minute," she said, and there was the slightest hint of anger in her voice. She was under so much pressure, his timid wife was getting defensive.

He continued to run his hand up and down her smooth leg, said, "What is it? What made you run?"

"Everything. I'm going to do it, Jonny. I will. I want to stay in this apartment. I thought I was ready but I'm ... I guess I'm not as prepared as I

hoped ...”

“It’ll be okay,” he said, running his hand up to stroke her knee, “I’m going to be right here with you.”

“I want you here,” she said, but then: “What are you going to think later?”

“I love you. I watched you last month, nothing changed, did it?”

“No.”

“I know why you’re doing this. We both know.”

He watched her, watched to see her face revealed, but she kept it covered. Her breath scored in and out of the gap between her hands. He sat with her for another minute, said, “He’s going to leave.”

Now her hands came away, and he saw a determination there. Reluctant but determined. Her jaw firmly set, her eyes narrowed and staring, looking at the spot where the cupboard under the sink met the tile floor.

She said, “I love our apartment. It’s our home.”

“It is, baby,” he said and rose to stand next to her. He held a hand out to help her to stand.

She wiped at her face, sniffed, looked up to him, her eyes wet and glistening. After her mouth twisted from side-to-side a few times, she said, “His thing.”

“What?”

“What made me run ... That thing between his legs, Jonny ... it’s too big. That can’t go in me, Jonny, it can’t.”

“It’s okay, baby, come here.” He took one of her hands in both of his and he helped her to stand, put his arms around her and she leaned her body into him.

“No, Jonny. Did you see it? It’s so gross, Jonny. I can’t ... I don’t think I can do this ...”

“You can do it, Charlie. You can do it, and I’m going to be right by your side ...”

CHARLIE WHISPERED, "OH, NO," again as they emerged from the bathroom, Jonny's hands carefully cupped over her shoulders, Charlie walking ahead of him. She was still naked, but had her arms folded across her bare breasts. On their bed they saw the man that was their landlord, also completely naked, laying with his back against the pillows, his legs straight out and parted. He was stroking himself.

He looked at them firmly, his brow lowered and stern, said, "You had five seconds left and I was out of here."

Jonny said, "She's okay."

He dipped his chin low and looked up at Charlie through his brow, said, "Are you?"

"I'm ready," she said.

"Good. Come here."

Charlie stepped away from him, his hands instantly cool in her absence. She made quick and small steps to the bed, still covering her chest, and climbed up and sat on her heels.

Reza said, "Are you going to waste my time again?"

"No, I won't."

"Charlie," he said, then got up on his knees and walked toward her until they were close. "I mean it. If you waste my time, I can't be convinced again. Tell me that you want this or I'm leaving."

She raised her chin to him, finding some confidence. "I want this."

"I'm going to take you."

"I know. I want you to."

Reza took the point of her chin between thumb and knuckle, tilted her head, her words had made him smile. His smile was cocky, pulling only to one side, his eyes sparkled as he examined her face. He got closer to her and Charlie closed her eyes. He kissed her on the lips and when their

mouths touched Jonny went weak again, a cord that held him upright severed. He put his hands out to either side to steady himself, feeling dizzy and overwhelmed.

He came to the side of the bed and sat on the very edge of it, putting only one butt cheek down, up near the pillows to stay out of the way. Reza kissed his wife. His mouth worked over hers and though she was stiff and resistant Charlie opened her mouth and let him put his tongue in it. It was awful.

They still kissed when Reza sought out her arms, running his big hands down to her slender wrists, then moving her hands to touch him between his legs. He was engorged but not quite erect. Large and swollen, but still hanging down. Charlie put her fingers around it, and Reza guided her other hand to cup his big hanging balls. Charlie grunted a squeak of protest into Reza's kiss. It made Reza chuckle then he broke away.

"You are a brave girl," he said, and ran her hanging mane away from her face and behind her shoulder.

"That's what Jonny said, too."

He put a hand around her neck, stroked her throat with the pad of his thumb, his other hand spread on her belly, fingers pointing down, and slid lower and lower, and Charlie tried to keep her face firm but her brows began to rise in the middle knowing what he intended to do.

Jonny watched as that hand dipped and touched her in her most private space. Right between the legs, touching her sex, Jonny being the only man to ever have done that intimately. But now his wife felt the touch of someone else. Her body began to shake. She made muffled sounds of protest and her thighs jumped and her hips bucked.

Jonny couldn't tell what he did, but assumed that he'd put a finger inside her because Charlie winced and bared her teeth. And Reza said, "You are very tight." Then he took his hand away, said to Charlie, "Come up and lay down, put your head on a pillow."

“Okay,” she said shakily. Reza said to Jonny, “Go up to the kitchen and get me some cooking oil.”

“Cooking oil?”

“I didn’t bring any lube.”

“What kind of cooking oil?”

“Whatever you have. Olive oil.”

“We need that for cooking.”

“Jonny, go get it and I’ll get you some more.”

Charlie lay herself on her back, her feet flat on the mattress. She kept her knees together. Reza bent and kissed each of them.

CHAPTER FOUR

JONNY GOT himself off the bed, tugged at his shirt to hide the arousal, walked backward to the kitchen, saw Reza get over top of her, his big thick muscular arms planting down on either side, his face over top of Charlie's, Charlie's legs opening for him. As he went up the steps into the kitchen, he saw them kiss again.

He banged through the cupboards under the counter to the right of the stove, saw they had no olive oil, only an eighth of a jug of vegetable oil remaining. He snatched it, ran to the pass-through and looked down over the pullout bed. Saw Reza's muscular back and bulging shoulders, couldn't see Charlie underneath him from this angle, only her slender white legs on either side of their landlord. His heart thudded wildly in his chest.

He beat a path back down to the bed, returned to the same spot and sat next to them. He listened to the sounds of their mouths working together, hearing quiet disapproving grunts from Charlie as this other man that she wasn't fond of put his tongue in her mouth.

"I have it," he said quietly.

Reza continued to kiss Charlie's neck and collar, kissing lower and suckling on the point of one of her nipples. They were deflated and unaroused, but as Reza plucked at them they hardened. Charlie grimaced.

Reza cupped a hand on Charlie's small knee, pushed it down so that it was flat and her leg lay on the bed, Jonny could see Reza's enormous tool laying on his wife's belly. He let Charlie's nipple go and her breasts shook.

He looked her in the eye but said to Jonny, "Oil it for me."

"Okay," he said.

He screwed off the cap, poured a little into the cup of his palm then got closer, reached between them, using the dry backside of his hand to trace inside his wife's thigh and spill the contents over her mound. He could feel Reza's hanging testicles rest on his knuckles.

He worked the oil into Charlie and she turned to face him while he did. Their eyes met as he ran his fingers through her familiar folds, spread some of the oil inside her, running his middle finger into her. He mouthed, "Okay?" to her, and she nodded.

Reza said, "Now me."

Jonny extended the jug of oil toward him. Reza still staring at the side of Charlie's face said, "You do it."

"Oil you?"

He said, "Do it, Jonny."

Jonny swallowed dryly, having great difficulty, feeling his throat sticking together. He took Charlie's hand and went to pour some for her to do it. Reza said, "Not Charlie. You."

"I don't want to."

"You will. You can't take care of this beautiful woman. You can't provide for her. And you let her lay on her back for another man to pay your bills. You want her to do *everything*?"

"No."

"Do something then. She can't do it all. Prepare me to enter your wife. You want it to hurt her?" He grinned and licked his lips as Charlie turned her head and they looked at each other.

Reza said to her, "He will ruin you if you let him."

Charlie looked away, looked into Jonny's eyes and said, "Don't, Jonny. Don't do it."

It made Reza chuckle, his thick back shaking with silent laughter as he suspended himself above her, watching her expression. He said, "Charlie, your husband has such nice soft hands."

"Don't do that," she whispered like she was scolding Reza, then her hand worked out from behind his muscular arm and she extended a cupped palm.

Jonny tried pouring another dollop, his hand shaking so wildly that he spilled some on the sheets. But he got her hand oiled. Reza's cock lay on Charlie's stomach, wrinkled and obscene, veins beginning to press out along his shaft, the brightness of Charlie's pale skin making it look even darker than it was. She slipped her hand down, cradled Reza's cock from underneath; gripped it, thumb running over the top, holding it very loosely, and eased her hand slowly up its length toward the tip. It was a long awkward moment where none of them said a thing and the only accompaniment was the sound of their breathing and the rustling of the sheets. Charlie stared at Reza without expression while he smiled.

Reza said, "Pull my foreskin back."

She paused, looking to object. "Okay," she said quietly.

Now she looked between them, watched her hand work as she took his foreskin in between two fingers, slid it rearward until the bulbous glans swelled out of it. Charlie's handling of his member had grown him very hard now. The veins stood out like cables. With her fingertips, Charlie worked the oil around the shape of Reza's glans.

"Get it all around the head," Reza said.

"I am."

"Charlie?"

"What?"

"Press your finger to the tip."

“Why?”

“Do it, Charlie.”

With the tip of her index finger, she pressed against the concave swell at the point of Reza’s huge erection.

“Run your finger around the hole, Charlie. Tell your husband how hard I am right now. Tell him.”

That big threatening weapon was fully prepared to enter his wife now. Charlie pressed against it and it swayed left and right, her fingertip barely mashing the head. She said, “He’s really, really hard, Jonny.” Then to Reza: “Okay?”

Reza smiled wide until his eyes narrowed to slits. He said, “Okay.”

Charlie looked at Jonny, her chin pointing up to see where he sat, her hands coming together to clutch nervously between her breasts, her fingers working together.

Jonny said to her: “I’m right here.”

“I love you,” she said.

“I love you too, Charlie.”

Reza got Charlie’s attention again, looking in her eyes, asking her, “Are you ready?”

She nodded.

Reza said, “Bring your knees up.”

“Okay,” she said, and slowly did what he told her.

Jonny said, “You really didn’t bring protection?”

Reza said, “No.”

Jonny said, “I don’t use condoms either, but I might have one in my dresser.”

Reza said to Charlie: “His little condom won’t fit me.”

She shook her head no.

“What do you do to not get pregnant?” Reza asked her.

“The Rhythm Method. Jonny pulls out.”

Reza laughed, said, “Old school. I like it.”

Charlie said, “Can you pull out?”

He said, “No.”

She blinked and watched him, saw he was serious. Now she wiped at her nose.

Reza said to her, “This might be uncomfortable at first, you’re very tight, but I swear to you—look at me,” he said and waited until their eyes met again, “you will like it.”

“Okay,” she whispered very quietly.

Charlie drew her knees higher, her thighs now blocking Jonny’s view of that medieval warrior drawn on Reza’s side. He said to her, “Put your feet over my back. And put your arms around me, too.”

“Okay,” she said and Jonny watched as her feet crossed behind Reza’s back and then her hands touched Reza’s very thick and muscular body. Jonny wondered if she was fondling him, enjoying his hard body—her nails running over the blades of muscle under his shoulder, up his ribs and over the bulging humps of his thick back, leaving a shimmering trail of cooking oil.

Reza said, “Are you ready?”

“No,” she said weakly.

Jonny said, “Charlie ...”

“I’m ready,” she whispered. “Yes, I’m ready.”

“That’s a brave, brave girl,” Reza said. He leaned on one arm so his other could line himself up to put it inside her. Charlie’s head flicked on the pillow, looked to Jonny, her face twisted with worry and fear.

“You’re okay.” He smiled for her. He couldn’t see between them, Reza’s muscular arm blocking the view, but he could definitely see Charlie’s face and knew the very moment that big thing pushed into her. Her eyes went wide but still squinted, her brow drew low, her mouth fell open and paused in an O shape, her jaw rigid. She gasped a high squeak. Now his arm came

back, and he hovered over her again, kissing at her neck. Jonny watched the muscles of his back work as he eased himself inside her, working his weapon in a small circle. Charlie made lots of faces now, eyes losing focus, gasping, biting her lip, her expression very concerned, then in the next instant showing pain, and then after that making an ‘ow’ face, and starting the cycle all over again. Reza continued, his hips going around in circles, not putting himself deeper, merely preparing her for his size.

“You okay?” he said again.

“Ow, yeah,” she said.

Jonny could see that Reza was now getting deeper, his hips not going in circles but driving forward. Charlie gasped, her nails ran down Reza’s sides, then her hands came to cover her face again.

Reza took both her wrists with one hand and cleared her face so he could watch her. He thrust himself a little deeper, and she complained. Now her hips began to wriggle and Jonny watched her toes flex. Charlie whispered, “It’s too big.”

Reza moved from her now, getting up, and Jonny could see that huge thing was halfway inside his wife. He took her ankles, held them as he eased himself out and then back inside her again, Charlie’s head thrusting back, open-mouthed into the pillow

Reza said, “Does it feel good?”

“No,” she gasped.

He said, “You feel very good.”

Guiding her ankles, he pushed her knees toward her chest. It allowed him to sink even deeper.

Charlie bit her own knee. Jonny watched as her perfect rows of white teeth grabbed a layer of her freckled skin and held it. She snorted through her nose as Reza plunged deeper still.

“YOU PROMISED you wouldn’t hurt her, Reza.”

“I’m not hurting her, Jonny.”

“Yes, you are—look at her face.”

Reza did, licking his lips. Charlie still bit a line of flesh over her bent knee; lips pulled back, sneered in a grimace. He said, “I’m looking at her—looking at that beautiful face. But, Jonny, I got a secret for you.”

Charlie’s head fell back to the pillow, lips sucked in her mouth and eyes squinted shut. Reza inched himself deeper.

Jonny cleared his throat and said quietly, “What is it?”

“You’re not going to like it.”

“What?”

“Charlie’s getting wet.”

Charlie grunted and shook her head rapidly.

Reza grinned. “She is, Jonny. You can’t tell by her face, but I’m inside her. I know the truth.”

“It’s okay, Charlie,” Jonny said.

“She’s warming up, Jonny. She can tell you she doesn’t like it all she wants, but her little pussy is loving it.”

Charlie gasped with disgust and threw her face to the side, shaking her head no again.

“It’s okay, Charlie,” Reza soothed her now. “I told you you’d like it. I told you it would feel funny at first but you’d like it. Didn’t I?”

Charlie didn’t answer, her chest and cheeks growing a cherry broadcast right before his eyes. Reza withdrew and shoved himself back in. Charlie gasped.

Reza said, “She’s loosening up, Jonny. It’s the way it happens. Little by little, she’ll start to like it whether she wants to or not, and then before you know it her walls will be gushing for me.” Now his hands touched along Charlie’s arms, taking her wrists and opening her chest up. He guided her hands up above her head and pinned them there into the pillows. He was

face-to-face over her, her knees bent sharply, her heels dug into his muscular back. He eased himself deeper then withdrew and Charlie moaned.

“Just relax, Charlie. It’ll be okay.”

“It’s too big,” she whispered.

“I can feel you stretching for me. Just take a deep breath,” he said, looking in her eyes. She met his gaze, and while Jonny was already turned on, there was something in the connection there between them that aroused him further but also angered him profoundly. She was listening to advice from this man. Listening to advice from another man on how to receive his oversized member. It was brutal and ugly, but somehow Charlie’s beauty made the moment soar.

“Breathe with me,” he said in his low mean voice.

As she inhaled, he slid himself in; as she exhaled, he let himself be pushed out of her. Together they worked on a pace, and the expression of pain disappeared from her face. Soon they were moving together, his back humping, his stomach muscles flexing, Charlie’s heels wriggling on his back, her toes clenching and unclenching.

“That’s it, ah, that’s it, take it for me ...”

“Aw, ah,” Charlie gasped and blurted, her face going red. The tendons on her neck stood out and Jonny saw her hands form claws at the apex of Reza’s muscular grip.

“That’s it,” Reza encouraged her again, rolling his hips forward and backward. “Listen to that,” he said to Jonny without looking. “Listen to her. Tell me she doesn’t like it ...”

Slick wet mucus sounds began to click between them. Charlie’s membranes relaxed and opened now, clinging desperately to Reza’s extreme girth yet accommodating him. His Charlie producing enough lubrication to ease the passage of his oversized manhood. Jonny watched, agonal gaze cast between them, seeing where Reza’s brutish hairy body met Charlie’s

alabaster perfection. Smooth skin meeting animal hide. Rolling against one another, that massive thing goring her; not rapidly not aggressively, but inexorably. Sinking deep, withdrawing and dragging her insides with it.

“That’s the oil,” Jonny said.

“Not just oil, Jonny, trust me,” Reza said.

Charlie whimpered, and closed her eyes, but her chest rose and fell with excited breath now. Her stomach rolled with Reza’s thrusts, her tummy bunched in thin lines the way her knees were thrust up to her shoulders. Now Reza changed his angle, pushing her knees even higher, almost touching her ears.

“Mm, no ...” Charlie moaned, but reluctantly allowed it, even taking her hands from his grip and laying them at her sides, pressed to the bed for balance. The angle of entry, straight up and down, showed Jonny how Charlie’s gleaming pink sex stretched to a tight ring around the base of Reza’s girth, how he plunged into her, how deep he must go ... Deep enough that Charlie blurted, “Ew, oh, stop, mm, careful,” and her hands rushed to Reza’s hips, her nails digging into him as she held him back from thrusting. Right hand searching, she found his cock, her grip going around the greasy base. “Yeah, mm, okay, yeah, like that,” she sighed, Reza continuing, smiling at Jonny as Charlie held his cock while it thrust in and out.

“Like that, yes?” he growled.

“Mm, yes, mm-hmm,” she hummed, eyes closed, face pinched.

“LIKE THAT?” Reza groaned.

“Like that,” she repeated in a delicate whisper.

“That feels good?”

Charlie sighed a quick rapid breath, said, “Yeah, feels good ...”

“You like it?”

She didn't answer but nodded.

"It feels so good," Reza said, giving it to her smooth and steady.

"Yes, mm, yeah," she gasped

He eased her rump down, knowing that angle was too much for her, settling her so the small of her back rested on the mattress again. He took the ankle closest to Jonny, put it on his own chest, let it scissor across him so both her legs were on the opposite side. She had one leg straight down the bed past Reza's knee, her other knee lifted over and pointed to rest on the mattress on the same side. It exposed her to Reza's intrusion and Jonny's view.

He could see her anus, her slick sex still gulping that thick size. Reza stroked in and out and watched Charlie's face. Jonny did the same, alternating from watching the painful lust in his wife's expression and the pure biological contact between her legs; the spreading of her soft mucous membranes by his blood-engorged tool, his own wrinkled membrane slipping up and over the ridge of his glans as it thrust into her then pulled out so the tip nestled in the twist of her pink folds.

Charlie liked it. There was no denying it. This had started terribly, so awful for his wife's psyche—terrible still now for him as he witnessed the love of his life enjoying the large pleasure of another man. Reza thrust, withdrew, thrust and withdrew, and Charlie writhed. While her hips were twisted away from Jonny, her back still lay on the bed, her head on the pillows.

It built in her. The lust becoming too much to contain, the pleasure spilling over, his wife began to moan. Her breasts jiggled with Reza's pounding, her hands gripped bedsheets, pulled them so they formed tight lines to where he lay next to her. Her nipples condensed like rough stones. She chanted. Humming, complaining, yet urging all the same. Saying yes, gasping no, shaking her head in the negative, nodding it in the affirmative.

Her breaths came quicker and quicker, and Jonny couldn't believe what was happening.

Then it was all positive: *yes, yes, like that, like that, yes, oh, wow, mm, yes ...* These exclamations were punctuated with desperate gulps for air. Her clenching hand releasing the bed sheets, looked for something firmer, nails scratching across the mattress, looking for her husband.

"Jonny, oh, mm, Jonny," she gasped.

"I'm here," he said, his voice tiny and weak. He took her searching hand in both of his, she dug her nails in his palm. Reza slipped it in and out of her, his knees planted in the bed, spread wide, his huge tool flashing in and out, her sex made wet sucking sounds, his huge balls drew up tight but still swung back and forth.

"Look at that," he said, and Jonny looked. But Reza meant Charlie, slapping her ass saying again, "Look."

Charlie's chin tilted forward, and she watched Reza's hard belly, the muscles rippling under his dense fur as he stuck his massive manhood in her.

She looked away shouting, "Oh, no, oh, no." She clenched her eyes, squeezed Jonny's hand even harder, and then she was coming. Orgasming, and so outrageously ashamed of her body's betrayal that she tried to hide it. She bit her lips, her face went a brilliant red, a vein stood out in her neck and she snorted wetly through her nose, drawing a long breath ... then unable to hide it anymore, let it all go in an animal bellow.

"That's it, that's it, come on that cock," Reza said.

Charlie shook her head trying to convince both of them that she wasn't coming. Veins rose in her arms, tendons and cables, her biceps flexed and bulged. Blades of her shoulder muscles jumped and twitched, and she held her breath again, the whole time Reza feeding it in and out of her. He leaned forward planting his hands on either side of her, in her armpit and by her breasts, his face over her chest; he pumped harder. His ass shaking and

jumping, the blades of muscles in his own arms standing out against his sweaty skin.

“Fucking ... take it, fuck,” he shouted.

Charlie hollered again; a release, a valve giving up its pressure. Shame laced through her lustful sound.

“It’s okay,” Jonny said, his voice shaky and unsure.

CHAPTER FIVE

REZA SLOWED; holding it in her, letting her squeeze it, his hand smoothed the globe of her haunch. Jonny could see the muscles of her sex twitching. Charlie was squeezing what had been put inside her. She softly moaned. Jonny ran his hand up and down her forearm while still holding her fingers.

“Fucking yes,” Reza said quietly. He ran a hand over her ribs and squeezed a breast. “Fucking yes,” he repeated.

Charlie came to very slowly, eyes fluttering, looking to Jonny and then being completely bashful. Her cheeks were still rosy. Her skin shone in the afternoon light.

“Up,” Reza instructed him. Charlie looked to him now, unsure. “On your knees,” he clarified. He withdrew his tool, slapped the big thing over her thigh, got out of the way so she could roll over and get on her knees and elbows.

Reza examined her from behind, jabbing her sex with his thumb, mashing her labia, slipping it inside her up to the second knuckle. Charlie squirmed, her hips swaying side to side. While he didn’t hold her hand anymore, Jonny reached to her and stroked her shoulder as Reza pushed himself in from behind.

“Ow-ahh, mm,” she blurted, feeling that huge thing reentering her body, her head thrusting forward her teeth clamping into the flesh of her forearm.

“Okay?” he asked her again. She just grunted.

Reza stroked in and out, his big hands gripping at the seam where her hip met her thigh. Jonny watched the flesh of her thighs shake as the thrusting renewed, growing quicker and harder, the wet sounds of his wife being gored growing in volume.

Charlie let her arm go and gasped another sound of intense but reluctant pleasure. Jonny soothed her, playing with her hair and rubbing her shoulders. It went on like that, Reza pounding her, Charlie making alternating sounds of pleasure and complaint, her hands gripping sheets, biting her arm, biting the pillow once, too.

After a long while Jonny wished he’d thought to put on music. It was too late now. All he had for company was the dirty sounds of their membranous connection, animal grunts from Reza and the sounds of his wife being fucked by another man. Also present: his own heavy breathing, his heartbeat in his ears, the scrape of the pullout bed’s legs on the floor, the thumping of the back of the couch seat against the wall below the kitchen pass-through.

All together, it put him in an outrageous place. A place of unreality. Another man was fucking his wife. Another man was giving it to her really good and Jonny sat back and watched. She took it, took it for the good of their home, for the good of their union, but everything about this was wrong. This was an impossibility. The interlocking pieces of the path that led them here were intricate and sharp edged, little failures, big transgressions ... then big failures. The path he built led them here—to this exciting tragedy.

The truth of it was: in it he discovered his most base pleasure, and in it he discovered the love his wife had and the devotion to their relationship. Charlie hadn’t wanted this at all. Yes, she had an orgasm on his huge cock,

but it had nothing to do with why she started this. She started because she loved her husband.

He got closer. Put his elbows on the bed with her, pressed his cheek against her shoulder, felt her body as it was rocked while their muscular landlord fucked her.

Reza's breath came faster and sharper, huge leathery lungful's of air heaving and emptying, and Jonny knew it was almost over. So he kissed his wife on the shoulder and he sat back to watch. Put his hands behind him sitting cross-legged, watched this hairy muscular man with his wife's perfect porcelain body, saw that monstrously fat thing between his legs as it went in and out of her, shiny with oil and her wetness.

"Yes, fuck, yes, here it comes," Reza said and his grip on her tightened, squeezing her so she protested. "Fuck, yes, take it," he shouted, their bodies slapping together, Charlie's thighs shaking nonstop.

Now Reza was coming; the sound of a bull in heat. Bellowing and heaving, a deep-chested animal roar. The veins stood out on his arms and he thrust himself deep in her and her chin went to the ceiling, her neck arched impossibly. She cried out. Cried out because she could feel another man ejaculating inside her body, a man that wasn't her husband.

She shouted his name, "Jonny!"

"I'm here," he cried, his face twisting up at her mournful sound (but the thing in his pants completely and impossibly upright). Reza drew back and bucked her harder. Jonny watched her hanging little breasts jiggle. She cried out again.

"Yes," Reza roared once more. He pulled back and thrust, Jonny could see the man's testicles held up high, hugging the sides of the shaft.

He collapsed over her back, his muscular arms on either side of her, his chin on her shoulder blade. Reza groaned, "Holy fuck, ah, fuck, shit ..."

Jonny leaned forward and stroked Charlie's upper arm.

“Yes, yes,” Reza moaned, his sleepy eyes fluttering, looking around seeing Jonny and then smiling. “This is gonna work out, Jonny. This is gonna work out.”

“Okay,” he said weakly.

“Yeah,” he said as he rose up, still inside her, admiring her back, running his hands up and down over her rib cage and smoothing the globes of her ass. “This is really going to work out,” he said, pinching the base of his cock. He pulled it out and Charlie moaned. He took the tip and held it still inside her stroking himself. Jonny could see white forming in the seal where he entered her and drooling out to the bedding.

“Look at that,” Reza said, more to himself than Jonny. He played with what emerged with the head of his uncircumcised cock. Then he looked at his watch, exhaled, took it and squeezed it over Charlie’s tailbone. More pearly drops splashed on her skin then Reza was lightly spanking her with it, smearing the wet. He backed off the bed, still breathing heavy.

“You okay?” Jonny asked Charlie. She made no sound but he could tell she nodded her head. “Lay back,” he said, “lay with me.”

Charlie fell to her side and spooned with him. He took sheets, whipped them over to cover her while Reza stood at the side of the bed looking for his clothes. They watched him dress, laying on the bed side-by-side, husband holding wife, while the menace in their life squeezed his muscular body into his expensive clothes.

When he was ready, he said, “This is definitely going to work out. Your wife is perfect.” He ran his hands through his hair and scratched at his beard, smoothing points to the ends of his mustache. “Charlie, you’re *perfect*,” he said right to her. She said nothing.

“Next month, count on it,” he said, pointing vaguely toward the bed, and he smiled, said, “Have a good night.”

They watched him as he climbed the steps up into the kitchen and listened as he opened the door, closed it behind him and walked down the

hall.

JONNY HELD HER, and she said nothing for at least ten minutes. That was all right, he could lay with her like this forever. Listening to her breathe, feeling her against him, knowing the depths she would go to prove their love for each other.

He pushed away something that tickled at him, something reminding him that he enjoyed it too much. To it, he spat back, *She enjoyed it, too!*

And that thought bothered him.

There was no denying her disgust for Reza and their pact with him, but there was no denying, just a moment ago while he fucked her she came. She came hard.

Soon Charlie was stirring, the quiet lacuna over. He rubbed her arm, like trying to put life back in a hypothermia patient. She rocked against him as he stroked up and down. “Was it okay?”

“Yeah,” she said.

“Did it hurt?”

“Yes,” she said quieter.

“And you sure you’re okay?”

“I’m okay, Jonny,” she said. Now she turned in his embrace and faced him. “Do you hate me?” she asked him in the most timid and fearful voice imaginable.

“Hate you? Oh my God, Charlie, I told you, I can’t hate you. What you’re doing is incredible ...”

“How can you watch me?”

“Because I love you. The same thing that allows you to do the deed is in me. It’s what makes me able to watch you. I watch you because I love you and I love our life together—the same reason you ... *surrendered* to him.”

Now her eyes welled up and trembled. Her hand came to his cheek, and she scratched him gently watching his eyes. He kissed her, took her lips and ignored the smell of cologne on her skin.

“I love you so much, Jonny.”

“I love you, too. This is going to work out. We’re going to stay.”

“We’re going to make it, Jonny,” she said as hopefully as he did.

“We are.”

They lay and stared at each other for a long while again, just feeling their warm bodies. After a while, Charlie said, “Could you go to the bathroom?”

“You need to be ... alone?”

“No, can you get me a towel?”

“Oh,” he said, “yeah,” wanting to ask why but maybe not wanting to broach the subject. His eyes darted over the sheet-covered shape of her body.

“Please, get me a towel,” she said.

“Yes, okay,” he said as he rose from the bed, glad that his arousal had dwindled enough to be hidden in the cup of his underwear. He trotted to the bathroom and fished out a dirty towel meant for the laundry. He brought it back, a big beach one that read Costa Rica, bright sunny yellow on an ocean blue background. A relic from their better times.

“Thanks,” she said, her hand reaching out from the bed sheets and forming a claw to grab it from him. He thumped down next to her as she took it, put it under the sheets; watched as her hands bunched between her legs, watched the expressions on her face as she tried to clean herself, saw her mouth wriggling around, her eyes rolling up and to the left. Heard—but kind of wished he didn’t hear—a greasy splurging down there.

He said, “Is it okay?”

“Is what okay?”

“The timing.”

“Yes,” she said. “I think so.” Then more rubbing, more elbows and knees pushing up, more wet sounds. She whispered to herself, “Gosh, how much comes out of him?”

That simple, barely registered remark had a huge and devastating effect on him. Not only was the man larger, noticeably so, enough that it provoked anxiety and anticipatory fear of his size, now his wife was noticing something else about sex with this other man: the volume of his sexual product. His stomach hurt.

Later that evening Charlie began to ache. They watched TV, sitting quietly together, and, under Charlie’s intense instruction, not talking at all about what she did that afternoon. That was rule number one. She got up to get herself a drink and her step hitched.

He asked her: “What’s wrong?”

She held her side and said, “It just hurts.”

He was next to her in a second, holding her waist. “Did he *rupture* something?”

“No, not like that. It hurts like the *muscles* hurt. And I feel like I have my period.”

“Do you have it?”

“No,” she said. “Just cramps.”

“Let me get you a drink,” he said and guided her back to sit on the couch.

Eventually he had to call work and tell them she wouldn’t be coming in the next day.

No, my wife won’t be able to make it today. Why?—she had vigorous sex with a well-endowed man while I watched and now she’s laying on the couch and her vagina is real sore.

That’s how it was at first with Reza.

Presently ...

CHAPTER SIX

TWO VOICES ECHOED in the hall outside the door that sealed his tomb. Both familiar; one deep and booming, voluminous in menace; in retrograde, the other was soft, high and kind. A light and lilting laugh came now, the voices growing closer; his Charlie's laugh, looping and bashful. Jonny moved himself closer to the kitchen door, ice cream scoop still in hand.

The voices grew quieter, like two people getting nearer to one another and sharing thoughts just for themselves. Low rumbling, Charlie calling back quietly, blithely. Giggling now. Then the sounds of fabric: a rustling of cotton, a squeak of leather—were they embracing?

Hushed sounds of farewell, another feminine chuckle, then the keys jangling in the door, her kitty-head key chain like a pendulum below the door lever. Jonny darted back to the kitchen counter on his tip-toes and waited, posed with scoop and Rocky Road carton.

When she came in, he looked to her casually as she stood in their small vestibule hanging up her things, saying, "Hey, look who's home."

"Hi, Jonny," she said.

"How was work?"

"Fine," she said, coming into the kitchen then making a shocked, frowny-face seeing him putting ice cream in a bowl. "You're going to ruin your dinner, Jonny."

“I was hungry,” he said.

Up on her toes she kissed his lips and rubbed his back. “Jonny, you’re not going to have ice cream for dinner.”

“What do you want to eat tonight?”

Arm still around him, she took the bowl and dumped his two rounded scoops back in the container. “We’ll have a real dinner tonight.”

“How?” he asked her. “We ate through most of the food you bought.”

“Leave it to me,” she said.

And now he was mad. Seeing her little charming self, rubbing his back and being cute with him and she’d opened her cunt for Reza today at lunch and earned them more grocery money. “Mm-hmm,” he hummed, showing her the slightest scorn. “Saw Reza today? *Earned* more money?”

“What do you mean?” she asked, her brow troubled.

“Make a little more cash at lunch today? On your back?”

“No,” she whispered, showing him her hurt expression. But he was onto something, he saw it in her trembling eyes. Charlie took the ice cream carton, squeezed the lid on it and walked it to the freezer.

“You can dance around it all you want, Charlie, I know you saw him today.”

“No, Jonny ...”

“I heard you two in the hall just now.”

“Oh.”

“Yeah, ‘oh.’ So, you’re seeing him during the day now? This isn’t the first time ...”

“It’s not like that, it’s—”

“Did you fuck him?”

“Jonny ...”

“Did you fuck him today?”

Her eyes welled up, took a tinge of pink right before him; his words hurting her. She whispered shakily, “Jonny, don’t be crazy.”

“Well then, what did you do with him?”

“You’re going to ruin it.”

“Ruin what? Your afternoon trysts? Where you spread your legs for him behind my back?”

Charlie took a deep trembling breath, said with forced brightness, “You’re going to feel so bad, mister.”

“What does that mean?”

“You’re going to ruin your surprise.”

“Oh, am I?”

She nodded, a childish grin tugging at her pretty mouth. “You’re going to be apologizing later.”

“Why?”

“I don’t know,” she said suspiciously.

“All right, tell me.”

“No,” she said defiantly. “I don’t feel like it now.”

“You’re keeping secrets from me. Lying to me.”

“What’s it going to take for you to calm down?”

“Why don’t you tell me what you did with him?”

“Okay.” Now her eyes rolled around the room as she came up with the most camouflaged manner to say what she wanted. “Reza and I went to a lawyer today.”

It was far worse than what he expected. A hard jab in his stomach. Worse than her meeting him on her lunch break and opening up her legs and doing that thing that she at one time hated. Scratching her nails on Reza’s back while he pounded her, hating that she needed it. This was worse.

He stated his greatest fear: “A divorce?”

The beautiful features of her face sagged, her jaw falling, her eyes going wide in horror. “Jonny,” she gasped.

“Is it?”

She took two steps to him, encircled him with her arms and held him.
“Jonny, how could you?”

“You went to a lawyer ...”

“You’ll see. You’ll see you’re being silly. Why would I tell you that was a surprise?”

“Because I never saw it coming.”

Her head darted back, and she looked in his eyes. She kissed his cheek.
“Surprises are good things, Jonny.”

“Tell me. Please, tell me why you went to a lawyer.”

She sighed and closed her eyes, moaned, “I wish I didn’t say anything.”

“How can you do this to me? How can you torture me?”

“Jonny, I did something today that will blow your mind.”

“Tell me, please, it’s killing me ...”

“I’ll tell you at dinner.”

“Can’t you just please tell me now?”

“I will tell you, unequivocally, we’re not getting a divorce. I’ll tell you at dinner. You have to wait till dinner. I saved us, Jonny, you’ll see ...”

AT SIX O’CLOCK, three loud knocks came to their apartment door and Jonny was sure it was Reza. His insides clenched tightly.

Charlie’s eyes darted to his, and she smiled, saying, “That must be dinner.”

It was a relief.

They’d been sitting on the couch watching another episode of The Twilight Zone. They were into the third season now. Not sitting closely this evening—not, as usual, with his arm around her, or her head on his shoulder, or her feet in his lap getting rubbed—tonight they were stiff and awkward and he barely paid attention to what they watched. He knew it was about a ventriloquist and his dummy; a dummy that was more than it

seemed. It was alive and evil. Then somewhere along the way he got lost in his own thought. The ventriloquist looked to lock the dummy away, fearing it. And then Jonny saw the dummy as he saw that part of him—that dark part of him that liked watching Charlie being taken by their cruel landlord.

In his imagination, he devised the shape of a box that would contain that part of him, lock his evil dummy away, help them return to where they were before. Though, he began to think, things were worse before. For whatever reason, now his life had structure. He worked hard. More than nine-to-five, seven-days-a-week. And while he would love to go and have free time, he did feel at home in front of his monitor.

Also, in a way, another man was slowly taking charge of his sex life. Gradually giving his wife what Jonny wanted her to have. And in trade for that bizarre sexual satisfaction?—bills were paid, rent was covered, they ate good food again. And, he wondered, should he lock that evil dummy in a box, how long would it take before it clawed its way out? And what kind of vengeful mood would it be in when it emerged?

Charlie trotted up the steps into their kitchen and went to the door, slid the chain out of the lock and opened it.

Not dinner. Not food. His worst fear: it *was* Reza. Standing there with a smile, a large champagne bottle tucked under one arm, the bulbous end wrapped in gold foil.

“Hey, beautiful,” he said.

“Oh, Reza,” she gasped, then looked sheepishly to Jonny as he sat silently watching from the couch.

“You going to invite me in?” he said, putting up one eyebrow.

“Of course, of course,” she laughed nervously. “Come on in.”

Reza stepped past her, looked in the kitchen, said, “Food not here yet?”

“No, it’s not yet.”

Reza seemed irritated, and Jonny watched them through the pass-through, saw the look of anger on his face, heard the knock of the

champagne bottle being thumped on the kitchen counter.

Reza tapped his phone now, put it to his ear and turned his back to them. Charlie tiptoed down the steps and joined Jonny on the couch.

“Reza’s here,” he said, stating the obvious but using his tone to communicate how displeased he was.

Charlie pat his chest and said, “It’s part of your surprise.”

A strange feeling of hope rose within him. Charlie was good; an angel. Perhaps there was positive news this evening.

He looked in her eyes and said, “What did you do?”

A wide and happy smile spread on her face, her eyes glistened with glee. Another knock came to the door.

CHAPTER SEVEN

“DINNER’S HERE,” she said quietly, then rose and kissed his forehead, whispering, “Don’t be a crab. Come and get something to eat.”

After a long drawn out sigh he followed, coming up the steps to join her in the kitchen as Reza opened the door.

“You were cutting it close,” he said to the young guy standing at the threshold. Black pants and a white smock, padded nylon bag at his hip, its wide black strap crossed over a shoulder next to a bold pheasant in gold stitching emblazoned on the smock’s chest.

“The Golden Pheasant?” Jonny said aloud.

Charlie turned and said, “You know it?”

He nodded. Sure. Only the oldest and most celebrated restaurant in the city. Reservations were made months in advance, dinners ringing the cash register at \$200 a plate. Not the kind of place offering home deliveries, so the fact Reza could bring service to the apartment was impressive. But he wouldn’t tell Charlie. “Yeah, I’ve heard of it.”

The waiter crossed into the kitchen now, Reza extending a hand out to bid him in. “Sorry, Mr. Khan, Chef called me back—she added something special for you, off menu.”

“Betsy’s a sweetheart,” he said, “I’m sure I’ll love it.”

The bag hoisted up to the counter, he unzipped the top flap and began transferring the contents to the countertop. “Well, Mr. Khan,” he said as he worked, “I’m Rainey. I’m here to serve tonight—if you’d like.” Plastic bags and containers and foil dishes spread out now, Rainey turned to shake Reza’s hand. “Shall we start with the Scottish langoustine?”

“I don’t think so, Rainey,” Reza said, shaking his hand. “You can leave it on the counter. Take the night off.” Now he withdrew the other hand from his pocket and opened a wad of bills.

“Are you sure, Mr. Khan? Would you like me to set up your plates?”

“Leave it to me,” Reza said, pressing three fifty-dollar bills to Rainey. “The kitchen is a little cramped for four, anyway.”

Rainey said nothing, but looked around the kitchen and out the pass through to the living area, tucking the bills into a pocket on his smock.

“Besides,” Reza continued, hoisting the bottle of champagne off the kitchen table, “my friends and I have ... personal ... matters to discuss. Something of a celebratory nature.”

Rainey spied the bottle, said, “A David Sugar? Must be great news.”

“It is,” Reza said, smiling at Charlie now.

“I’ll get out of your way then, let you get eating. Oh—Mr. Khan, this one,” he said, holding up a small white plastic bag with a square cardboard carton inside, “this is from Chef, made specially for you. Sea urchin from California, with bergamot caviar. And, you’ll celebrate with the Krug, but chef sent a bottle of 2012 Saumur–Champigny, a Clos Rougeard, with her regards.”

“Thanks, Rainey, tell her I’ll be in touch,” Reza said, guiding him to the front door with his emptied bag where they stopped and talked quietly a moment.

Charlie regarded Jonny again, hands in the pockets of her skirt, eyebrows high, expression bright and blithe, but her mouth pursed with a tension.

He said, “If your surprise is I get to have dinner with Reza, I hate to break it to you—”

With a comical scowl she kicked him gently on the ankle and whispered, “Just wait, you.”

When he reached over and kissed her, gently holding the back of her neck, Reza returned, ruining the moment. There was a lot he wanted to apologize to his Charlie for. Firstly, for being a dick when she arrived home today, but there was much more. Stuff he couldn’t quite fathom, how his inabilities had become somehow fetishized, and while they suffered under Reza for the sake of their home, there was much about it that he secretly enjoyed. And he hated that he did.

“I DON’T KNOW shit about wine,” Reza said, palming the bottle the Chef had sent and reading the label. “Anyone object to starting with the champagne?”

Jonny said, “I just really want to know what the good news is ...”

“Hey, Jonny,” Reza said, noticing him for the first time.

“Hi, Reza.”

“Can we tell him now?” Charlie asked Reza hopefully.

“That’s up to you, Charlie girl.”

Charlie wrung her hands together, then said to Jonny, “C’mon, let’s sit at the table.” She pulled a chair out for him to sit. As he put himself down, Reza transferred the cartons of food to the table, then went to the cupboard for plates.

“Can you just please tell me,” Jonny pleaded as Charlie took a seat next to him. Hands under the seat, she shifted and jerked, the legs squeaking as they scraped the tile, until she faced him. Behind her, Reza removed the foil from the champagne bottle, then unwound the tin wire casing.

Charlie began: “So, Reza ... recently Reza had a windfall—”

“A windfall?” Jonny said.

“I sold my penthouse,” Reza said. “Glasses?”

Charlie turned in her chair and said, “Um, cupboard. The one next to the fridge. But we don’t have any wineglasses.” Reza grunted and opened the cupboard. Charlie continued: “Yeah, so, he sold his penthouse, and for a really big profit, right, Reza?”

Reza thumped three short drinking glasses on the kitchen table and said, “Yes.”

“He had a ...” then she looked up to Reza for confirmation, “a bidding war?”

Reza said, “Three parties interested. They drove the price up one-point-four over asking—and asking was high.”

“Right,” Charlie said, “so, he ... he ended up with a lot more than he expected.”

“That’s really great,” Jonny said morosely.

Charlie faltered, her smile fading, but then it quickly returned; her hands however, wrung together nervously. “He gave me the money to pay off the Chinese.”

The cork popped like a gunshot and they both jumped.

Charlie laughed and turned to see Reza pour champagne in her glass.

Jonny’s fingers went ice cold, a nausea swelled up within. “What?” he murmured.

As Reza leaned close and poured champagne in Jonny’s glass, Charlie said, “I paid the debt off, Jonny. The Chinese are paid in full.”

“What? It ... you can’t ... how?” A million questions jumbled inside his husk of a skull. “*You* did it? *You*? He *gave* you the money?”

Reza poured himself a glass as well then sat down next to Charlie, a wide smile pushing up the pointed ends of his mustache. A hand went out and held Charlie’s neck, thumb rubbing up and down. Jonny jumped in his chair like another cork popped.

“Charlie, what did you do?” he said.

“We went to the lawyer at lunch today, Jonny, and I signed a promissory note and he gave me the money, and right away the lawyer issued the money to the Chinese guys’ lawyers. You’re out, Jonny. You don’t owe them anymore.”

Elbows up on the table, he put his face in his hands and breathed deeply. “But, Charlie—”

“What?” she said abruptly, a tinge of fear and sadness in her voice. He peeked through his fingers and saw her cheeks turn red.

“Charlie. We owe Reza now, don’t we? Why would you do that?”

“Interest-free, Jonny. Interest-free. The terms are our own, no one else knows them, our debt is hidden, we can ... we can rebuild our credit.”

“Interest-free? Seriously?”

Reza nodded, his hand still on Charlie.

Charlie smiled now, seeing him accept the good in what she’d done. She said, “Fourteen-hundred a month, Jonny, for five years, and it’s all done. Five years and this will all be over.”

Fourteen-hundred a month was easily manageable. What Charlie had done put them in a much better financial position given the circumstances. Reza’s hand on her told him the rest of the story. “He can take you whenever he wants, can’t he?”

Charlie ignored his question; though she smiled he saw her eyes glistened wetly. The smile disappeared as she sucked her lips between her teeth.

Reza said, “Let’s toast Charlie. Jonny, with one stroke of her pen today your wife saved you almost thirty-grand in interest at the rate you were going.” He hefted one of their cheap drinking glasses filled with expensive champagne and said, “To Charlie.”

Jonny’s hand shook as he took up the tumbler, but he raised it to toast his naïve but wonderful wife. “To Charlie,” he agreed and took a sip of the

champagne.

Charlie took a deep breath and smiled weakly, taking up her own glass and raising it toward him, saying, “To Jonny.” She took a long deep drink and set her glass down.

While she was quiet a moment, her eyes lowered to the table watching her hand hold the glass of champagne, all Jonny could think was that Reza could take her anytime he wanted. Did it mean anytime over the next four years? When he’d encouraged Charlie into this arrangement, he never looked far ahead. That evil dummy in him just *needing* to see her with Reza. One time. That was all. Just her mouth. Then it was more. Then it was sex. Just once though. Then once a month—but it was up to them if it occurred. Reza bought 80K worth of Charlie fuck credits today, but he didn’t think Charlie saw it that way, only saw that she had done well for her husband.

A smile forced on his face, he reached out and took her wrist, pulled her close to him, hand now held in between both of his. He whispered, “You did good, Charlie. You did so good and I love you.”

Relief slumped her posture, and she exhaled, saying, “Really?” A tear spilled from one eye and trickled her cheek but she wiped it away. She whispered, “I’m sorry I didn’t tell you, Jonny.”

“I would have said no. But it was the right thing, Charlie. You saved us a lot of money.”

“Right, Jonny?” she said. “All of what we paid already was just interest.”

He kissed her fingers as Reza opened cartons, steam rising from them and curling up in the lampshade that hung over the table.

“That’s just part one, Jonny,” she said in a cheerful whisper.

“Part one what?”

“Of your surprise,” she said, slipping off her chair and getting on her knees before him, taking both his hands in hers now. At the table, Reza

removed a small orange lobster-like creature from a carton and examined it.

“There’s more?” Jonny said.

Over her shoulder, Charlie cautiously looked at Reza, and he took a long arm of the weird crustacean and moved it as though it waved to her. He winked.

Charlie looked back to Jonny and said, “How would you like to work on your game full-time, Jonny?”

“How?” he asked, his voice rising with disbelief.

She licked her lips and looked at him directly. “I told you Reza sold his penthouse ...”

“Yeah,” he said with an apprehensive chuckle. “Like, a minute ago ...”

“He’s going to build a house just outside of the city.”

“Good for him,” Jonny said.

“He’s got the land. He has a contractor ...”

“Okay.”

“So—now listen, Jonny—he’s going to pay all our rent, utilities, internet, cable, everything, even our food—”

“Oh no ...”

“He’s going to move in with us while his house is built.”

“Charlie,” Jonny moaned and pulled his hands away from her.

She chased them, rose and stood between his open legs, saying, “Jonny, Jonny, listen, please listen ...”

“No way, Charlie.”

She held his cheeks in her palms and steadied his face so he would look at her. “Only six months, Jonny. That’s all. Listen—look at me. I’ll pay the debt, he pays the bills, you have six months to work on your game and *only* your game, baby, *please*, I love you.”

Watching her emotions brought tears of love to his own eyes now, and he sniffed wetly. The cost was enormous, but he saw what she would do for

him and his love for her grew inestimably. His heart literally swelled in his chest and his mouth fell open, his breath hitched. “W-what?” he stammered.

“Six months, Jonny. You’ve got six months, okay?” She blinked tears away again. “Six months to make me proud, baby. I’ve always believed in you ... I know you can do it.”

He pulled her to him and embraced her so tightly his hands formed shaking fists. Tears were squeezed from his squinted eyes and his eyelashes fluttered.

Across the table, Reza stared at him, smiling balefully.

CHAPTER EIGHT

WHILE THE FOOD prepared by the celebrated chef at The Golden Pheasant was probably excellent, it rolled in his mouth like tasteless mush, sitting now a quivering bolus in the pit of his stomach. The fizz of the champagne helped, and he welcomed the dullness it brought his mind.

During the meal he held Charlie's hand. Couldn't help stewing over the development and how it came to pass. Charlie made small talk while she ate, light and inane, shot through with her evident self-consciousness. It made him consider what brought it to her—was it a certain shame?

A worry came to him that part of sweet Charlie entered into this parlous contract with their landlord to feed something within her. Jonny might not be the only one with an evil ventriloquist's dummy that needed to be locked away in a sturdy oaken chest. By signing a promissory note in secret with Reza—without her husband's counsel—she had guaranteed herself a long sentence in sexual servitude to their swarthy and obscenely endowed landlord. Was it all love for her Jonny or did his timid girl have a deep itch that Reza relieved?

Eyes on her perfect profile as she ate and tried to make easy the worst situation a young married couple might find themselves, a chilling guilt crept up his back. How could he think of her that way? The sacrifice she made today was enormous and there was no doubt she'd done it because

she loved him. That was honest. The feelings she had for Reza were known: she held the opinion he was offensive. Never had she expressed an interest in him before the agreement, and the night she'd been coerced into fellating him, she'd retched afterward and sought the cleansing of bleach to remove his remnants from her pallet.

However, Jonny, she orgasmed regularly from his thrusting, didn't she?

But even Charlie was bewildered by that, wasn't that true? Didn't acknowledge it, or even want to talk about it when it was brought up.

Jonny?—didn't she tell you she asked for it that night in the limo? Begged him to fuck her if I recall.

She hated that she did, and she was driven to it—Reza had teased her and she expected it ...

Begged him to fuck her, Jonny.

"I gotta stretch my legs," he said abruptly, and stood up from the table, letting Charlie's hand go.

"Where you gonna go?" Reza laughed, joking about the size of his apartment, he supposed. Now made much smaller by Reza's huge presence.

"Don't you want dessert?" Charlie asked him with a sanguine smile.

"I'm full," he said, and moved his chair away to leave.

"You okay?" she asked him and he didn't answer.

As he stood at the top of the two stairs that led to the living room area, something in him tugged. *Just open the door, Jonny, open it and run out to the street, and run and run and don't stop running till all of this is just a distant memory ...*

That was something he would never do, not when Charlie had done so much. Slavery to his console was his six-month sentence. He'd show her. In six months he'd have something. *His game*. A year from now he'd have so much money he'd pay Reza double to get his wife back. Maybe even give ten-grand to Demetrius to put on a ski mask and throw fists at Reza. A

grand per punch, a grand for every punch that landed in the chin, mouth, and nose area, maybe even—

A loud yet tuneful knock on the door.

“That’ll be for me,” Reza grunted from the table where Charlie remained with him sipping champagne.

Great, now he was receiving visitors here. Already standing next to the door, Jonny opened it—

Speak of the devil.

Demetrius said, “Hey, what’s up, Jonny?”

“Hey,” Jonny said.

Demetrius stood in the hall with another man, a white guy wearing a suit stretched out by his muscular bulk. In one hand, Demetrius held a suitcase, in the other a strap that led to another suitcase, this one behind him on the floor resting on wheels. The muscular man, a handsome sort of guy with thick sandy hair brushed back from his face, curls on his collar on either side of his wide neck.

“That Demetrius?” Reza asked from the kitchen.

“Yeah,” Jonny said, stepped aside, waving a hand to invite the two men in.

“Ha ha, hey, look at you, Mr. Domestic,” Demetrius said to Reza, brushing past Jonny and trundling the case on wheels, Jonny darting his toes back to avoid having them run over.

“Hey,” the bulky guy said, brushing past him, also laden with two bags, one in hand, the other on a strap over his shoulder; just like Demetrius his load also emblazoned with the LV pattern.

Jonny stood at the back of them, watching around as Reza wiped his mouth and beard with a napkin. Charlie stood as well, turning, an expectant smile up to the blonde-haired one, her expression bright.

“Hi, Tate,” she whispered.

The one she called Tate took a step toward her, Charlie looking up into his eyes. “Hi, Charlie, how’s it going?” he asked her.

“It’s good,” she sang softly, running her hair behind an ear and tilting her head.

Demetrius said to Reza, “You want this stuff down by the bed?”

Reza grunted, “Yeah, take it down.”

As Demetrius passed to go down the stairs, Jonny said, “I guess he’s moving in tonight?”

Demetrius laughed, “Sure look like it, don’t it, Jonny?” and trotted down the steps.

“Hey,” Jonny said, loud enough to get the attention of the guy talking to his wife. He turned away from Charlie and Jonny said, “Down here,” gesturing to the living area. As he came to the stairs, Charlie following behind, Jonny put his hand out to shake saying, “I’m Jonny... This is my apartment.”

The guy eased the bag on the strap behind his hip, and took Jonny’s hand, dwarfing it in an iron grip and shaking, saying, “I know, Jonny, I know all about you. Nice to meet you, I’m Tate.”

Jonny nodded, giving him a serious face, letting him go. As he made his way down the steps, Jonny stopped Charlie, putting a hand out and resting it on her middle as she tried to pass.

“Who’s your friend?” he said in a low voice.

She said, “Tate? He went out with us that night to the club. He was in the limo.”

Ah, the limo. So he would be one of the men who rubbed their cocks through their pants while they watched you blow Reza. “Okay,” he said and let her pass, his stomach twisting painfully.

Reza approached and Jonny slipped down ahead of him, joining the others near the couch that was their pullout bed. Demetrius and Tate waited

for Reza to tell them what he wanted, and Charlie stood near Tate, her fingers laced together, forearms across her hips.

Reza came around Jonny now, bumping him, saying, “I don’t know, I guess just leave my bags outside the closet door. There’s, like, no room here at all. Just put ‘em down there. My stuff from the penthouse will be in storage, I’ll just have you bring things in and out as I need them, week at a time.”

Jonny scoffed loud enough Reza turned to regard him.

Tate looked around and said, “Small place for three,” and let it hang.

Jonny followed up: “I know. It is. It’s so fucking obvious ... Why would someone want to stay here when they could rent a luxury apartment, a house, shit, stay at a four-star hotel ...?”

Reza could stay anywhere he wanted. He had the resources. He could come and go and still fuck Charlie every day if he wanted. No, him moving in with them was one-hundred times more about fucking *with* Jonny than it was about *fucking* Charlie.

But Reza stayed silent, slowly folding his arms while staring Jonny down with great menace.

“I’m staying here, Jonny, because I care about Charlie. She married a loser but Goddamn if she doesn’t believe in him. I’m doing it to show her. Prove me wrong. You’ve got six months to show the woman you married that you’re a man. Prove you deserve her. If she were on the market, I know a dozen *real* men with bank that would sweep her off her feet and give her everything a woman fine as she is deserves. You’ve got six months to show Charlie the truth. Are you the piece of shit I think you are or the hidden gem she sees? ... Tick tock, Jonny.”

The room fell deadly silent as Reza continued to glare and no one said a thing. Jonny swallowed dryly and looked away from Reza.

Demetrius burst out, “Oh snap, dude. Jonny should’ve kept his mouth shut.”

Charlie said, “Jonny’s not a loser. You’ll see.”

“THIS IS RIDICULOUS,” Reza said, one hand dug behind the seat of their fold-up bed, Charlie on the opposite side doing the same. You have to do this every night?

“It’s no big deal,” Charlie said, pulling up, and together she and Reza walked the bed as it folded out of the seat like an accordion, amidst the groaning of metal and a twanging of springs.

“It’s fucking annoying,” Reza said, forcing it down, banging the feet on the floor.

“There’s a lock in the middle,” Charlie told him, “you swing it around and it holds it in place,” as she clicked her lock around.

“Holy fuck,” Reza muttered, stooped down looking for the lock on his side.

“Do you see it?”

“No,” he grunted.

“Do you need me to come—”

“I got it,” he said with irritation, swinging the lock around and standing.

Jonny watched from the other couch, scowling and stewing and not helping.

“Okay?” Charlie said to Reza while he surveyed the bed.

“Fuck,” he said, “where are the sheets?”

“In the closet,” she told him.

“This is such bullshit,” he muttered, stepping around his suitcases and going into the closet. “I don’t know how you live like this. Like fucking college students.” He flicked the light on and looked around. “Where?” he demanded.

“The column in the middle, third shelf up,” Charlie said.

Reza returned with an arm full of bedding, saying, “These?”

“That’s them,” Charlie said. “Fresh from the wash,” saying it brightly, trying to lighten the guy up.

Reza spotted Jonny now and tossed the folded linens onto the bed. “How about you fuckin’ help out here, Jonny?”

“Fine,” Jonny grumbled and raised himself heavily from the couch, crossing over to the bed. While Jonny and Charlie folded out sheets, snapping them in the air, Reza unbuttoned his shirt and removed it.

“Here,” Reza said abruptly, moving around to the other side of the bed where Charlie stood.

“What?” Charlie said, a tinge of fear in her voice. Reza stood next to her, hairy and thickly muscled, tattoos on his side and up his neck, wearing only suit pants. He withdrew his wallet—alligator, matching the belt he wore—and plucked from it a credit card, offering it to Charlie held between two thick fingers.

She took it from him carefully, her body language guarded. “What’s this for?” she asked.

“I can’t sleep on this thing,” he said. “Tomorrow, go out and get a king-size bed.”

Charlie said, “We don’t want a big bed in our living room.”

Reza said, “Too bad. I’m not sleeping on this for six months. Buy a really good one, frame and all, get bedding and pillows too. Have them deliver it. Set it up.”

“I have to work tomorrow,” Charlie said.

Reza groaned and shook his head at Jonny, indicating that Jonny didn’t make enough so his wife didn’t work. He said, “You, Jonny. You do it. Go buy a proper bed.”

Jonny said, “I have to work, remember? I’ve got six months ...”

“I’ll do it,” Charlie said, putting the card away in a pocket of her shirt. “I’ll go after work.”

“Good,” Reza said. “And once you sleep on it you’re going to thank me.”

“I know,” Charlie said.

“Go somewhere good. Go to Ashley Bennett out in the West End,” Reza said, undoing his belt.

“That’s far.”

“Take an Uber. Put it on the card.”

“Okay. How much can I spend?”

“Huh?” he said, drawing down his fly. “Spend whatever. Get the best. The day I worry about the cost of a bed is the day I take up designing video games.” He let his pants drop to the floor, his heavy genitals in a pouch that pulled the waistband of his white underwear to sag at the front. Charlie looked, then looked away at Jonny, keeping her face expressionless.

Reza watched the side of her face as he pulled his briefs down and stepped out of them, his huge, hairy penis swinging between his legs.

Charlie’s cheeks went red as she watched Jonny, but she turned and regarded it hanging there, looked up to the ceiling and said, “Can we ... Can we watch TV first? Jonny and I like to watch TV before bed.”

“Sure. Sounds good,” Reza said, stooping to collect his discarded clothes, folding his pants as he returned to the closet, walking past Jonny completely naked.

To Jonny, Charlie said, “Can we put our PJs on?”

Jonny nodded, shifting his thighs as the little thing he had swelled in his underwear. “Yeah,” he said.

Reza put a suitcase up on the bed and opened it while Charlie went behind into the closet and came out with her PJs. She looked at Jonny quickly, chewing her lower lip, over to Reza’s naked back, then slipped into the bathroom and locked the door.

CHAPTER NINE

REZA WORE an expensive silk robe with a wide velvet collar, leaving it untied so the tassel ends of the belt dangled and swung just as his exposed penis did. Up in the kitchen now, he picked through a carton of leftovers and finished the champagne. Charlie sat next to Jonny on the other couch, wearing a light shirt and sleeping shorts, Jonny in an old T-shirt and sweats. She regarded him plaintively, head cocked, one bare foot up on the couch seat, chin on a knee.

“It’s just for six months,” Jonny, she whispered.

“I know,” he said, fidgeting with a game controller.

She put a warm hand on his arm and he took it and held it. “Jonny, when ... when you see me with him ... remember I’m doing it for you.”

He nodded.

“I’d do anything for you, Jonny. I love you so much.”

He nodded again, eyes welling up; when he turned to face her his arms leaped around her and he embraced her, Charlie’s hand stroking his back. “I love you more than anything, Charlie,” he whispered.

“We’re going to get out of this, Jonny. I know we will. My Jonny won’t let me down.”

“I won’t, Charlie, I swear I won’t.” He sighed, kissing at her sweet neck.

“What are we watching?” Reza’s deep voice said, Jonny looking past Charlie and seeing their landlord coming down the steps naked but for a robe over his shoulders, flowing behind him like a cape. In one hand he held the bottle sent from the chef, two glasses pinched in the other.

Charlie sat back wiping at her cheeks, saying, “The Twilight Zone.”

“Cool,” Reza said, looking at the paused screen, setting the glasses down and withdrawing a corkscrew from a pocket in his robe.

Jonny pressed play, and the episode began while Reza uncorked the bottle. It was hard to follow along as everything Reza did distracted, but they watched as a husband and wife returned to the husband’s childhood home, his controlling mother passed away, looking to prepare it for sale (like Reza’s expensive penthouse).

Reza poured two glasses of wine, looking to Jonny and saying, “You didn’t want any wine, hey, Jonny?” Jonny shook his head no. Charlie took up the glass intended for her and offered Jonny a sip but he passed.

On the couch, they sat and watched as the episode progressed, Jonny on one end, Reza on the other, Charlie between them. The husband on the show has a hard time letting go of the past and the wife senses the mother’s terrible presence (Jonny could definitely feel Reza’s presence in his periphery; he could see beyond Charlie’s lap, while Reza’s robe closed over, it was still untied, and his thick patch of pubic hair poked up in the gap). Charlie still sipped at the fine wine.

On-screen, the husband becomes so rapt in childhood memories that his deceased mother becomes manifest. Her presence literally transforms the husband into a child (kind of how Reza’s sharp words did, belittling him in front of his wife and Demetrius and some man they called Tate).

Reza finished his glass of wine, leaned forward and rested it on the table next to the bottle. When he sat back, he tugged on one side of the robe, exposing a bare, hairy leg and part of his stomach. Jonny noted Charlie’s grip tighten on her glass.

Reza took his penis and draped it over his thigh, its wrinkled nose pointing toward Charlie. She took another drink of the wine and tried to focus on the show. The wife challenges the ghostly mother, and she denies any wrongdoing (right—she had *nothing* to do with it). Reza tapped his penis against his leg impatiently and Charlie whispered, “Can I watch the show first?”

Reza took his glass from her and set it on the table next to his, sat back and lay both arms over the back of the couch, embracing Charlie and pulling her to lean against him. She did, nestling into him with his arm around her, his heavy flaccid cock still over his thigh; the wrinkled ugly thing resting in the seam of his hip.

Reza whispered in her ear, and whatever he said had her glancing to Jonny, apprehension squeezing her face. Now Jonny watched in the corner of his eye as Charlie’s pale little hand lifted that thing off his leg and squeezed it, tugging on it gently. He was unaroused, his enormous penis pliable and elastic, and Charlie played with it while they watched on the screen as the spectral mother and an infantilized husband chased the wife away, chanting *We don’t need you anymore!* (and Jonny would use the next six months to prove he was needed! Needed and oh-so-worthy.)

REZA TURNED to regard Jonny over top of Charlie’s ginger hair. “That the end of the show?”

“Yeah,” Jonny said, looking over, his eyes lowering to see directly what Charlie did to him with her hand. Saw that garish piece of huge flesh wriggling and swinging from the end of her grip as she tugged and stroked.

“Put on the news,” Reza said.

“All right,” he said quietly. Then switch the TV over from his hard drive to a news channel on YouTube. Reza hugged Charlie with his arm and kissed the top of her head. He shifted in his seat so that his hips faced her,

one knee coming up over her lap. He stroked her arm as she continued to work him with her little hand, then cuddled her breast through her shirt, his eyes lowered to watch his big hand on her narrow chest.

Charlie was reluctant to let him, but knew there was no point in denying him. She folded her shoulders forward as if she didn't want Jonny to see him do it, leaning forward as well so that he couldn't see the thing in her hand. They'd done this so many times you'd think it would be easier for her. The fact it wasn't could be good news or bad news.

It would make more sense if she grew comfortable handling Reza in front of her husband. It had happened quite a few times already. Once again he thought of her shame. She was the kind of girl to feel that way, not be able to come to grips with the darkness that might be inside her. Not know how to handle that little piece of her that desired some of this. Jonny lay his palm in the centre of her back and let her feel that he was here with her.

Her shirt ruffled, Reza's fingers moving around, his hand tugging the shirt higher to slip underneath. Reza whispered, "Open your legs."

Saw then Charlie's knee closest to him angle outward, allowing their landlord to put his hand inside her shorts and touch her between her legs.

"How's this?" he asked Reza finding a live stream on YouTube.

"That's fine," Reza said. "You don't have cable?"

"I cancelled it."

"Reorder it."

"Okay," Jonny said quietly.

Then to Charlie, Reza said, "Come here," and he guided her up to her knees, taking her elbows and rotating her, Charlie putting a foot down on the floor, getting between Reza's knees and facing him. Jonny saw that thing between his legs large and heavy, not fully erect but definitely fatter and extended, still flopped across his leg, the foreskin closed up but the shape of his swelling glans visible underneath. Charlie lowered to her knees

onto the floor between Reza's open legs. "That's it, Charlie, just get it good and hard for me."

"Okay," Charlie whispered, her hands clutched together at her chest. When she was squatted down on the floor, Reza leaned forward and pulled her T-shirt up over her head, Charlie lifting her arm so he could do it. Now she was topless and Jonny saw the hardened buds of her nipples that she attempted to hide with her arms.

"What are you waiting for?" he asked her.

"Nothing," she said, eyes turning up to his. She lifted his thing up again, holding it in both hands and looking at it, used her fingers to retract his foreskin, her mouth pursed. She leaned forward, let her tongue sag over her lip and ran it in circles on the underside of Reza's cock head.

"That's it," Reza groaned.

Soon she was working, her mouth sinking the whole glans past her lips, tongue swirling around, her cheeks sucked in. Jonny had grown to steel. She bobbed and slurped, Reza watching her, brushing her hair back from her face so he could see better.

He sunk back into the couch seat and let her work for a while. Charlie held it by the base with one hand, her other cradling his big balls. Jonny watched her pale fingers make dented impressions in his very dark scrotum.

While Charlie worked, Reza's eyes grew sleepy, and then he had a hand fishing inside the pocket of his robe. He withdrew a white paper cylinder, holding it up near his face then smelling it, Jonny realizing it was a rolled joint. From his other pocket Reza withdrew a silver lighter.

Joint poked in his mouth, eyes squinting, two hands came up to light the end while puffing. He closed the lighter with a snap and it disappeared back inside his robe. The whole time Charlie's head bobbed between his legs, her eyes turned up to see what he did, eyelashes fluttering.

Reza breathed deep, held it, then exhaled a rolling white cloud of skunky stink. Charlie kept sucking, closed her eyes to ward off the smoke's

sting. Reza grew completely stiff in her grip, the end third glistening with his wife's spit, veins rising up against the skin. When Charlie pulled back, the foreskin rolled over to cover the glans again. Then she stroked, the opening winking at her as she watched the tip of him.

"That's it, keep going," he urged her, taking another long drag from the joint. "Jonny, pass me one of those glasses."

Jonny leaned to the coffee table and took Charlie's almost empty glass and handed it to Reza, who took it and ashed the joint, making a hot little sizzle that echoed in the glass.

He gestured the joint to Jonny and raised his eyebrows asking him if he wanted to partake. Jonny shook his head no. He would be clear-headed for the next six months. There was much to do.

Reza watched the news through half-lidded eyes while he smoked the joint low. Robe wide open, hairy and naked, the whole time Jonny's sweet wife bobbing; sucking and stroking his huge hard cock.

CHAPTER TEN

“IT’S HARD NOW,” Charlie said to Reza, holding his cock at the base, the huge thing fully engorged and pointing to the ceiling. The other hand wiped at her spit-soaked mouth; lips pouted and puffy, eyes wet and worried, she said, “You want me to keep going? Want me to make you come?”

“You like it when I come in your mouth?” Reza asked her.

Charlie stayed plain-faced, not answering him. Reza cupped her cheek with a big hand, sighing as he admired her perfect, freckled face.

Reza said, “I love coming in that pretty mouth, Charlie.”

She whispered, “You can if you want to.”

“You’ll swallow it?”

Jonny drew his feet up onto the couch, secretly pushing his erection down and squeezing it between his thighs.

Charlie nodded that she would swallow, her eyes on Reza’s.

“Stroke it,” Reza instructed her.

As her lips sucked into her mouth, her hand came up and lightly stroked his thick shaft.

“Pull my foreskin down,” he said.

One hand on his shaft, she used the fingertips of her other hand to delicately peel back his unsightly skin, exposing his prodigious cock head. Now her eyes darted from it to Reza, looking for her next instruction.

“Put your tongue on it,” he said.

The glistening pink point of her tongue parted her lips and pressed to the underside of his cock, slipping up and down where the glans met the shaft.

“That’s it ... now the hole, lick the hole ...”

Charlie angled his cock toward her and ran the tip of her tongue in the deep cup of his urethra. The thing looked as large as a plum.

“Now stroke it again ... Stroke it and squeeze my balls ...”

Charlie complied, one hand stroking, tongue darting and slipping around his urethra, her other hand lifted and cupped his scrotum, fingers wriggling, squeezing and tugging.

“Mm, that’s it,” Reza moaned, leaning back and taking another long drag, holding, expelling up to the ceiling. Hand cupping her face again, their eyes on one another, he said, “Or I can fuck you,” he said.

Tongue out, stroking and tugging, Charlie nodded her head.

“You like it, don’t you? Like it when I fuck you ...”

Charlie retracted her tongue, wiped her lower lip with the upper, let his balls hang to wipe at her chin with the back of her hand. She didn’t answer but continued to stroke him.

Reza rolled his head on the seat cushion to regard Jonny. “She does, Jonny. Your wife likes it when I fuck her. You know—last time, when we went out?—you know, she begged me to fuck her, Jonny.”

“I know,” he said, his voice breaking.

“You know?” Reza said, disappointed surprise in his voice.

Charlie said, “I told him. I won’t keep secrets.”

Reza said, “You did? Such a good and loyal girl. I mean it, Charlie.” He stroked her cheek again, Charlie’s hand paused holding his erection, and he said, “You are so perfect. Too good for Jonny. Smart, beautiful, honest, pure ... You could do so much better ...”

“I love my Jonny,” she said with a weak smile.

“We’ll see,” Reza said.

Charlie’s features sagged, and she lay Reza’s cock up onto his hard, hairy belly, stroking her palm up and down the wide underside. Quiet and blinking, watching her hand on it, finally she said, “Can we go to bed now?”

“You want me to fuck you?”

“Yes,” she softly sighed, eyes lowered.

“Say it.”

Jaw set firmly, she looked in his eyes, saying, “Take me to bed and fuck me.”

“My pleasure,” Reza said, a smile spreading his thick black beard as he leaned forward to rise. Charlie stopped him, two hands taking his wrist, one sweeping up to take the joint out of his hand.

“Good girl,” he said, standing over her, Charlie on her knees on the floor still. Turned to the side, Jonny looked at his enormous cock poking out of his open robe, slick and glistening, almost straight out, looming over his wife’s head. Reza ran his fingers through her hair, turned and walked to the bed, shrugging the robe off his shoulders.

Charlie held the stubby joint to her lips, inhaled and held, eyes to the floor.

Jonny whispered, “You okay?”

She nodded absently, took another long puff, rose and dropped it in her wineglass where it extinguished. Now she stood before him, the same Charlie he knew—caring and innocent but on the apparent verge of frightening transformation. Topless, wearing only shorts, hard cherry buds stretched from her creamy meager bosom. She exhaled plumes of smoke from her nose, saying, “You’re sleeping on the couch?”

“I guess so,” he said, wafting her smoke away with a hand.

“Sorry,” she whispered, helping chase the smoke away with both her hands.

Then she was gone, turning on a heel and crossing the room with her arms folded over her chest. Reza sat in their bed, naked, his arousal poking straight up, the tip resting against his sternum. Charlie passed the foot of the bed, going around the other side. Reza removed his gold watch and set it aside on the table next to the pullout.

Charlie disappeared in the closet, Reza watching after her. When she emerged, she held a blanket clutched to her bare chest. She went to the bed and snatched one of her own pillows then trotted across the room back to Jonny. He drew in a long shaky breath, swelling with love for her, watching her return to him.

“Here, baby,” she said, presenting him the blanket and setting the pillow down for him, resting over the couch’s arm and patting it once in the middle.

“I love you so much, Charlie,” he whispered, taking hold of both her wrists.

“I love you, too, Jonny,” she said. Then, “You going to be okay on the couch?”

“*You’re worried about me?*”

“Yeah,” she whispered back to him, brow twisted with incredulity. “Of course.”

“You’re so special,” he said and kissed the inside of one of her wrists.

“You’re going to show him, aren’t you, Jonny?”

“I sure am,” he said firmly.

She pressed her lips to his forehead and let it linger in a long, warm and loving kiss. When she drew away, he took the back of her neck and pulled their lips close together, sealing them with another kiss of his own. The taste of weed, the taste of salt and the scent of cologne from Reza’s cock lingered on her lips but he didn’t care. She pulled away with a wet smack, a smile stretching her lips wide. They stared at one another and Jonny watched that bright smile wane, her features settling to an expression of

reluctant resolve. When she stood and turned, she paused, reached for the bottle of wine on the table and pulled three long drinks, face turned to the ceiling. Bottle set down, she wiped at her mouth and without another word walked to the bed where Reza waited.

FROM THE BOTTOM of the bed she climbed up on all fours. Reza said to her, "I don't want you kissing him before we're together."

"Okay," she said, coming up to sit on her heels at his side. "Sorry."

"That's all right," he said. "Take your shorts off."

Charlie ran her fingers under the waistband, rose up enough to scoop them over her rump, rolled back to sit down and brought her knees up, drawing the shorts down her legs and off her feet. She tossed them aside, then hugged her knees, chin planted, waiting to be told what next.

"Open," Reza said, touching his fingers between her shins, his other hand holding onto his cock. "That's it, perfect," he said as her legs slowly parted. "Sit back and show it to me."

Charlie leaned back on one hand, heels dug in the mattress, legs open, and while she showed Reza her vagina, she shyly covered her breasts with the other forearm. Now she looked between her own legs to see what Reza would; lowered a hand to ruffle her labia, then returned it to cover up her breasts.

"Come to me," Reza instructed in a low voice.

With her legs closed again, she twisted until she was on her knees, walking then till she was beside him.

"Climb over," he said, the hand holding his cock pointing it upright.

She regarded it, then lifted a knee to straddle him, his erection slipping up along the crack of her tight ass.

"Kiss me," he said, looking in her eyes.

She shook her head no.

He spanked an ass cheek, making her flesh jump, said, “Charlie,” in a stern tone.

Her hands resting on his muscular shoulders, she lowered her lips to his. Reza leaned to kiss her, both his big hands palming her ass cheeks, parting them, grinding his hips so his cock slipped up and down the crease. Their lips made soft smacking sounds together, both of their eyes closed. Charlie’s fingertips pressed harder into his shoulders, and Jonny noted her own hips beginning to roll against the stroking of Reza’s cock against her.

One of Reza cupped hands slipped low, the middle finger extending, the tip probing against Charlie’s pink stripe. It broke Charlie’s kiss, and she gasped at his touch.

“Somebody’s wet, Jonny,” he said while looking into Charlie’s eyes.

She grunted and shook her head no again.

He palmed her ass, pulling her to sit higher, the tip of his uncircumcised cock coming to rest in the nest of her membranes. Now his palms rested on the high crest of her buttocks and he guided her down while his hips thrust up, gradually impaling her. Jonny watched his girth mash her, push all her pinkness in, and Charlie tilted her chin up, sighing, “Ohh, mm, oww ...”

Reza worked it up and down, Charlie assisting, raising and sinking in small increments. The shine her insides left on Reza was evident. Charlie *was* wet.

With his hand still bracing the swell of her rump, Reza pumped himself in and out of her, just feeding her half of what he had and Charlie’s sex sounded hungry for it; making wet popping and smacking noises. They fucked like that for a while, getting a feel for it, getting warm, and soon Charlie was breathing heavy, the fingers of her ribs pressing out against her pale skin.

The pace grew quicker, the two of them bouncing now, the back of the pullout banging against the wall below the kitchen pass-through. Charlie’s long, shaggy, apricot hair swung against her back and their pounding

brought breathy gasps from her now. When Reza took a nipple in his mouth she moaned and raked her nails through his hair.

Reza fed her more inches, and it brought muffled grunts of discomfort from Charlie who fell against him now, feeding him her breasts, her two hands spread out on the wall behind him. When his hand stroked her ass, a middle finger slipping along her crack and pressing against the tight rosebud of her anus, her rocking stopped. Her head shook in protest but she said nothing. As his finger probed, Jonny watched Charlie's breaths come now in deep chugs. He inserted the tip of his finger inside.

"Oh, no, no, don't do that," she hissed, raising so she could see his face.

Reza wiggled his hips, sinking more of that wide cock inside her, making her moan a long dry sound.

Most all of Reza's cock inside her, now he sought to penetrate her further. He looked in her eyes and she returned the gaze, hers trembling. He withdrew his hand, brought it to hold her jaw. She took her shook her head no again. Now he pressed his ring finger to her lower lip, fed it to her, and she accepted it, letting him sink it all the way into her mouth.

His thrusting resumed, Charlie riding his hips, titties jiggling, mouth sucking on their landlord's finger. When he plucked it from her mouth she gasped, "No," again, but her body never stopped rolling with his deep fucking.

This time when his hands swooped over her ass cheeks she didn't shake her head, instead digging her nails into his shoulders in anticipation of his finger's penetration. A whine began in her throat as the tip of his finger drew close; when it breached her she let out a wrenching mournful sound.

With half his ring finger inserted in her anus, Reza's grip clamped her ass tightly and his hips powered into her. They got the bed banging against the wall again, the feet scraping the floor. Reza's huge balls slapped up and down, into the sheets and spanking Charlie's ass. The cries built in Charlie until it became an omnipresent wail, warbled with Reza's powerful

hammering. He studied her face, watched her as she he gave her pleasure, watched as Jonny's shy and demure wife turned into a simpering harlot on his massive cock.

When the time was right—and Reza seemed to have poor Charlie figured out—his thrusts drove deep, buried it and held; Charlie's back arched, chin thrust to the ceiling, Jonny reading the grimace on her upturned face, her hands changing from claws to fists, the right one pounding on Reza's collar as she bared her teeth and snorted.

"Oh, mm, ah, mm," she choked through gritted teeth, and while he gored her deeply, he flexed his hips up and down letting her still ride him.

"That's it," he growled, "come for me, Charlie." His free hand spread open on her chest, stroking up and down as she rode out the orgasm, and as it subsided, the hand closed around her neck.

Then he was rolling forward with her still impaled on him, throwing her back so her head hit the mattress, beautiful hair fanned out around her, him over top, legs out wide, Charlie's draped lazily over his hips. The pounding resumed, Jonny seeing that fat cock driving in and out of her, Charlie snorting again, spittle dashing over her lips, two hands coming up to grip Reza's wrist. He tore away one of her hands and thrust it low between them where they were joined.

"Stroke it," he demanded, and Charlie tried to get a hold of his driving shaft. "No. Here," he hissed, pinching the middle of her palm and forcing her fingers to press into the hood of her stretched labia, mashed up above where he penetrated her. Charlie's fingers clumsily rubbed herself and her mouth opened and closed at the shocking pleasure of her own touch. "That's right," Reza told her, "faster now." The grip on her neck released, he planted both hands into the bed on either side of her face, his muscles rippling as he fucked her even harder. "Faster!" he hissed, staring into her tightly clenched face.

“Mm, mmph,” she blurted, then swallowed her lips, her brow deeply furrowed. Her hand buzzed over her clit in a blur while he fucked her, two middle fingers mashing down on herself.

“Yeah, fuck, keep going,” he growled, pounding hard and fast.

Charlie howled suddenly, eyes bursting open wide but unseeing, and she writhed in the sheets, twisting left and right as Reza made her come again even harder than before.

“Fuck, yes, fuck,” he grunted, driving hard and deep with each word for emphasis. Charlie moaned and cried as he did. Her glistening hand came up and covered her face.

Reza said, “You like that, Charlie? You like getting fucked with a real cock?”

Both hands on her face, her head shook from side to side.

Reza said, “Well, your body fucking loves it,” and kissed the back of her hand. “Come on, Jonny is watching, let’s show him.”

REZA SLIPPED his huge hog out of her with a gushing sound and slapped her tummy with it, then stepped to the side of the bed, taking Charlie’s knees and rotating her body so she lay crossways on the bed. Jonny squeezed his iron cock through his sweatpants, his stomach tight and hard but fluttering, his own face pulled into a grimace like Charlie’s.

His view of the action now was from behind—Reza’s wide, muscular back, his bare ass, and as he spread his legs wider, his low dangling balls swinging from side to side—Charlie’s feet over his hips, but as he pressed her knees up to her chest, they bobbed over his shoulders.

Between Reza’s legs, Jonny had a clear view of his wife’s gored sex, dark pink, shining, and left spread. Reza pushed his cock in and it opened to welcome him. Five months ago she could barely take it, stayed home from work after their encounter, now her sucking hole craved its size.

“Hurry, hurry,” Reza urged, shifting his feet, waiting for Charlie to get comfortable.

Her fingers appeared at his waist, and she shifted, wiggling sideways, her pussy stretched fantastically wide by Reza’s girth. Jonny heard her voice uttering an okay.

Reza’s feet shifted again and then he was pounding once more. Deep, steady; his balls striking her rump, sticking a moment from their damp, then swinging again. The muscles bulged on his back and Jonny could tell he was close. It wasn’t more than fifty pumps like that before his arms shook and he thrust deep into her and held. Then out and in again, harder, and he roared, his head thrusting up and down, his testicles rising high, one of them slipping inside his body. Charlie’s feet flexed and her toes curled, Reza’s legs trembled, then he let out his breath in a freight train roar.

A thin line of bright semen spilled around Charlie’s penetration and ran to the floor in one long stream before it became rapid drops. Reza’s back swelled and heaved, his breaths bellowed, and when he pulled his cock from Charlie, semen disgorged in a wicked flood. Reza stroked the fat end of his cock up and down her sex and Charlie whimpered with reluctant pleasure. With a shaking hand, Reza stroked himself, wringing out the last of his semen and flicking his cock, dashing white strands over her labia and across her mound. Charlie’s hand appeared, slipping through the mess he’d spewed on her, running her fingers through it and massaging her sex, light glinting off her gold wedding band.

It was too much to take. Knees drawn to his chest, muscles flexed in barricade, an unstoppable eruption spurted from Jonny regardless, and he clamped a hand over his mouth to stop his ecstatic sounds from being heard. Once it started it wouldn’t stop, one blip at first, then, surrendering, becoming long pulsing streams of his hot semen spilling into his sweatpants.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

DESPITE THE HORROR he'd witnessed, Jonny slept soundly and didn't wake again until dawn, opening his eyes and being treated to the vision of another man laying in the bed where he should be sleeping. Flat on his back, sheets pulled up to mid-chest, his hairy chest thrust up in a proud hump from the flat horizon of the bed. Reza slept with one forearm across his brow, his thick black beard hiding his remaining features, leaving it very easy to imagine an escaped zoo animal had curled up in his bedding.

Another hump crested the flat line of the pullout. Morning wood. Reza dreaming perhaps of what he'd done to another man's wife while that man watched (Oh, the ways he made her come! Oh, her cries of ecstasy!), or perhaps just a bursting bladder; whatever the means, the man was frightfully engorged, that cannon pumped with plasma and pushing up the sheet past his navel.

One thing missing from this morning's panorama: a second hump under the sheets; a smaller, shapelier form he'd expected to see beyond the unseemly palisade of the man who had contracted his (hopefully) unwitting wife into sexual subjugation. His head darted from the pillow, lifting to look, snorting alertness into his lungs, the hand he held his neck with falling dumbly along his chest. A frightened gasp escaped him—the sudden awful realization the hand that held his neck was not his own. Torso wrenching

reflexively on the couch seat, he came face to face with Charlie, asleep behind him.

“Oh, baby,” he sighed, touching her cheek while she still dreamed. Sometime in the night she’d returned to him while he slept; climbed over, snuggled under the blanket and fell asleep with her arm around him. Those pouted lips of hers puffed with the silent snore of her sleep.

Drawing the blanket down, he saw she’d dressed in fresh PJs; now in a royal blue tank top and a pair of white cotton panties. With the tip of an index finger he stroked her side, the funny feel of cotton burning a tickle on the pad. Over her rib, across her narrow waist, bumping over the trim of her panty where it crossed her thigh ... No flutter in her lashes, he let that finger slip the cotton, low over her hip, tracing the shape of her mound, finding the swell of a panty liner, hearing its crinkle.

Now her eyes opened, narrow slits accepting light, that green sparkle under her lashes as she grew conscious. She smiled a narrow restrained seam.

“Good morning,” he whispered.

“Good morning, Jonny,” she whispered back, her smile growing more comfortable seeing the warmth in his eyes.

He kissed her, and she dragged her nails on his neck. The hand already between her thighs stroked at her mound with the backs of the knuckles and she flinched warily. The hand wouldn’t take no for an answer and it slipped into her panties, pads of his fingers wedging between the hot flesh of her mound and the gauze of her panty liner.

“Jonny, don’t,” she whispered but did nothing to stop him.

The cleft of her mound was hot and glutinous, his finger slipping along to separate her cloven halves, finding her labia hot and inviting. The fusty smell of Reza’s remains wafted from her tented panties and rolled between them; neither acknowledged it, his Charlie gasping silently at his touch while he examined her face.

“Did he fuck you again, after I fell asleep?”

“No, Jonny.”

“He only came inside you once?”

She nodded, eyes wide on his.

“Are you sore?”

“A little.”

“Want me to stop?”

She shook her head no, her expression less one of lust and more one of duty: Jonny was her husband.

His finger stroked up and down on her, their eyes darting over one another, and it wasn't long before propitious sounds were conjured from her sex. His other hand tugged the front of his waistband down and his erection sprang out.

Charlie's eyes darted to it, and she giggled mincingly, her hand leaping to cover her mouth. “Oh wow, Jonny,” she sighed around the hand.

Wiggling closer, she stroked it, both of them shifting to be comfortable, their knees touching as they faced each other on their sides. “We have to be quiet, Jonny.”

“Okay,” he said, his massaging fingers parting her legs wider and narrowing her eyes. “You like that?”

“Oh yes, Jonny, shh ...”

Between his legs Charlie's hand stroked his meager endowment. Not something he was ashamed of but he had witnessed that same hand on another penis last night, and the other dwarfed his. Charlie's hand formed a ring of three fingers and thumb, her pinky held out of the way to make room for ample stroking. The head of his cock was small and narrow and often obscured by her index knuckle. Reza's cock dominated her fist; made her grip struggle to close. Two hands could be used.

“I look so small in your hand,” he whispered.

Her brow furrowed, and she asked: “Your penis?”

“It’s so small.”

A smile came now, and she laughed. “I love your little boy penis.”

“Little boy?” he said a little too loudly.

“Shh-sh, not like that, Jonny—I mean a boy’s penis, like a cute boy from school ... like you; you’re my cute boy from school.”

Their foreheads pressed and both their hips ground at what they did to one another with their hands.

“Mine’s a boy’s ... Reza’s a man’s?”

She groaned. “I don’t know, Jonny.”

“You used to hate his dick, Charlie.”

“I do hate it, Jonny. It’s not yours.”

The point of his index finger cornered her clit in all her sopping membranes and worked it until she shivered. Then he said, “You come on it.”

“Don’t,” she squeaked.

“Tell me, Charlie. I see you do it, why won’t you just admit it?”

“I do admit it, Jonny. I said it before. I don’t want to ... but he makes me ...”

“Come?”

“Yes, he makes me come. Why ...?”

“Why what?”

“Why do you ... you came when you watched me ...”

“How would you know? ...”

“I smell it, Jonny ...”

“Yeah.”

“Why do you get hard ... why do you come when you watch him with me?”

“I hate that I do ...”

Her back curved, pressing her forehead harder against him. She said, “Are men’s ...”

“What ...?”

“Mm, are men’s ... bigger?”

Now his back was arching, and the feel of her hand went slippery as he spurted silvery lubricant over her thumb. “What do you m-mean?”

Her hand slicked with greasy ease now. She hissed, “Reza, Demetrius ...”

“Yeah?”

“Are all of them ... would Tate be big like them ...”

“Ah, oh,” Jonny flitted on the edge of fainting at the first and narrowest glimpse at a blackness that may be within her; a sliver of shade slashing through the most timid and perfect girl in the world.

She asked him now, seeing his reaction: “You’re going to come?”

“Ah, yes, mm, a-ask me ...”

“What ...?”

He groaned, “Tate ...”

“Would his be big?” Her voice a soft, high, and unsure whisper.

“Probably ... I bet it is-s ...”

“He is?” It came out as a breathy gasp, a surreptitious giveaway that this was good news to his wife; and right there Jonny’s love for her galvanized on this secret part of her that she unknowingly revealed, a part she might even hide from herself.

Jonny whispered, “If he *was* big? ...” He licked his lips and watched her faraway face, her narrow and glassy eyes, her pouting lips panting with the thrusting of his hand through her dirtied sex ...

“Yeah ...?”

“Ah, would you come on his cock?”

“Oh, Jonny, oh, no,” she whimpered, her eyebrows bowing up in the middle, drawing her smooth brow in a furrowed bunch. But she came. Her hips bucked against him, a thigh folding over to clamp his hand, her mouth parting, eyes closing, a draggy creak drawn up her fine cabled neck.

The sight of her like that, a glimpse inside her dark cave, the way lit by the dull shine of a weak lamp—had him joining her. Watery semen squirting from him with great excitement, Charlie feeling it and thrusting his cock inside his sweatpants to mitigate the mess, her thumb running maddening circles around his urethra while he launched the rest inside his pants.

They bucked and squirmed together, both grunting and writhing from the effort to remain quiet and not wake their landlord while they orgasmed. Then both grabbed the other's wrists to stop their ticklish touching, both of their orgasms leaving their dirty bits hyper-sensitive. Charlie exhaled breathy laughter and Jonny added his too, chuckling through his nose and pressing foreheads again.

"WHY WOULD YOU SAY THAT, JONNY?" she whined, her tone perturbed but her smile unmistakable.

"To make you come," he said, looking in her eyes.

"Oh, Jonny ..." She smirked, then sucked her lips into her mouth and clamped them with her teeth, that smile tugging the corners of her smile higher. "Don't say things like that."

Now he smiled, too, eyes darting over hers. "It worked."

She shook her head and rolled her eyes, both her hands shoved in his pants, not to touch him but to clean his ejection off her hands.

"Did we wake him?" he asked her as he rubbed her shoulder.

Still drying, she peeked around Jonny and looked at the bed. "No," she giggled. "He's still sleeping."

Jonny wondered what she thought when she saw the huge hump of his morning arousal, if it provoked something carnal within her, or, like he saw a moment ago, a sense of tragic duty. Could it be both? He supposed it could. Charlie was honest with him at every turn; her selflessness was legitimate, she surrendered to Reza for Jonny's sake, and she hated sex with

him but perceived the inkling that something inside her responded to his brute sexuality.

“You going to buy a new bed today?”

She shrugged her shoulders, her hands slipping up to rest on his stomach and chest. “He’s paying ...” She made a sudden funny face, her chin darting to her neck. Mouth working around, her face pinched like she’d tasted bitter lemon. Now her lips pouted and puckered like she imitated a fish, eyes squinted shut. Mouth open, jaw working side to side, her hand came up and thumb and forefinger inserted into her maw, held in a pincer.

“What are you doing?” he whispered.

She shook her head no, eyes wide open now, rolled up and to the left, speculatively, her index finger scratching at her tongue. Though she tried to hide it, flicking it from her thumb, he saw that she’d removed a long, coarse, black pubic hair. She wrinkled her nose, then kissed his chin. “I have to get ready for work.”

“Okay,” he whispered. “Want breakfast?”

The thought was sweet, but the truth was they had little in the cupboards right now. They’d feasted this last week on what she’d earned on her back that night in the limo and the club, but they were depleted. Unless Reza left some of last night’s dinner untouched, there would be scant choice. The truth was, and he saw it in her virtually blank expression, she would bat her eyes for ‘Daddy,’ tell him she was hungry and he would give her money for McDonald’s or whatever she wanted in her tummy.

She admitted it with: “I’ll get something on the way to work.”

It occurred to him—he said, “On his credit card?”

She shrugged then climbed over him.

What would he say? Deny her a simple pleasure? Her sacrifice was enormous. Her reward in this endeavor wouldn’t be limited to seeing her

husband prove Reza wrong. What she did for her husband deserved compensation, consolation, wherever Charlie may find it.

He held her arms as she straddled him, one foot on the floor, her hair hanging down around him. He looked in her eyes and said, "I'm going to make you proud, Charlie."

She smiled, said, "If there's anything in this world I still believe in, it's you, Jonny."

They kissed and breathed a long time, then she pat his chest and sat up. "Shower time," she whispered. He watched her rise, her long freckled legs dance across their apartment, looking sweet and hot all at once in just a tank and panties. When she put her hand on the door to the bathroom, Reza said, "Where you going?"

LIKE A DEER CAUGHT IN HEADLIGHTS, Charlie paused at the door, hand still on the knob but rolling the point of her shoulder forward to hide her breasts. "I have to get ready for work."

Reza watched her from the bed, inched up higher with his elbows in the mattress. He breathed deeply. "Come here," he said.

Charlie looked to object, waffled for a moment, then joined him.

"That's my girl," he said, sitting up with his back against the pullout's cushions. His arousal made a tall ghostly tent between his legs.

"What?" Charlie asked him, on her knees at his side, aware of his erection but looking at it sideways. Reza gripped his cock over the bedsheet and when she regarded it he stroked.

She said, "I have to go to work ... and I'm ... tender ..."

Reza's other hand crept the bed, worked between her thighs and stroked her sex over her panties. "What's this?" he asked her, and Jonny heard the crinkling of her panty liner.

"Nothing," she said.

“That time of the month?”

She shook her head no. “You came inside me and then ... I leak.”

“Just change the bedsheets.”

“It tickles when I leak.”

Reza smiled, his hand moving to stroke her cheek, Charlie closing her eyes as he did. Then he took her hand and guided it under the sheets, put it to grip his cock.

With his hands laced behind his head, his hairy muscular chest thrust toward her, he leaned back and let Charlie jerk his cock. Jonny watched the denting of the light fabric as her little hand went up and down his huge column, Charlie on her knees still.

When slick sounds began under the sheet, Reza’s knees moving in and out, his chest heaving with lusty breath, he urged her: “Mm, faster, Charlie.”

She complied, her eyes roaming from Reza’s face to the bumping of her knuckles as she stroked him, the muscles of her shoulder flexing and jumping. He groaned and moaned, his eyes closed, feet moving up and down under the cotton. Charlie went faster and faster, her hand gripping just the glans now, probably rolling it up and down that huge cock head, her hair shook with her rapid movement. Then Reza was grunting and kicking, his hips driving up to meet her hand and from under the sheets, the motions she made produced slick wet bubbling sounds.

“Mm, ah, mm,” Reza, groaned as he shot his semen under the bedding. Charlie continued stroking but slowed, now watching Reza’s masculine chest rise and fall with his heavy breaths.

Under the cover, she held his cock for a long while until Reza’s eyes opened again and he breathed a deep satisfied sigh. She pulled her hand free, held in a curled claw, palm cupped upright, thick shimmering strands of Reza’s semen dangling. He stroked her cheek again while she wiped her hand clean with a bunched up wad of the bed sheet.

“You were my girl, you’d do whatever you want today.”

Charlie ignored him, saying toward the bed, “You think I could use the card to buy some breakfast this morning?”

“The card I gave you? Sure, Charlie, buy breakfast, buy whatever. Treat yourself, okay?” he said, now brushing her long curly hair from her face and back over her shoulder.

She nodded a little, whispered, “Okay.”

“Okay?”

“Thank you.”

“You’re welcome, Charlie.”

Without saying anything more she backed off the bed, her eyes averted and she closed herself in the bathroom.

The room was quiet a moment, then Reza turned his head toward the couch. “Morning, Jonny.”

“Morning.”

“How’d you sleep?”

“Just fine.”

Reza sat up now, bunching the sheets around his cock and wiping at it. “Dream up your big game?”

“I already know what I’m doing.”

“Good for you, Jonny. Good for you.” Now Reza rose, stood on the same side of the bed as Jonny completely naked. His cock glistened, hanging half engorged, thick and past halfway down his thigh. “Shit, I gotta piss,” he said, handling that big penis, looking at the closed bathroom door. “I can’t do this one bathroom thing.”

Jonny said, “She won’t let you in there. She’s very private about her bathroom time.”

Reza went to the door and knocked anyway.

From the other side of the door, Charlie’s tiny voice said, “I’m in here.”

“I know,” he said. “Can I come in?”

There was a long pause and Reza began to smile. Finally she said, “No.”

Reza winked at Jonny, still squeezing his own dick. “Charlie, I just gotta piss, okay? Let me use the can, I’m bursting.”

There was another long pause, the sound of Charlie doing things in there. Reza bounced at the knees, squeezing his cock tight. “Charlie, I’m going to shower at the gym. But if you don’t open the door, I’ll piss in your kitchen sink ...”

“Hold on,” she said behind the door. More banging, fissing paper, then the door unlocking and Charlie opening it for Reza. She stood in a short robe, her legs and feet bare.

“Thank you,” he said dramatically, walking past her while she stood by the door still like a sentry, her arms folded across her chest.

The toilet seat banged up and then there was a frothing explosion of urine in the bowl as he released his bladder in a torrent through his firehose of a cock. Charlie leaned her back against the open bathroom door and waited. The thunderous splashing went on uncomfortably, ending in spurts and longer jags of resumed streams, then his back muscles flexing as he shook his tool off.

He turned and strolled to the door, touching Charlie’s waist as he passed, saying, “All yours, beautiful.” Charlie flushed the toilet for him then closed the door again.

The day was off to a very good start for Reza and his face showed it. With a satisfied smile and peaceful eyes, he gathered his clothes, unfolding the pants he wore yesterday and putting his legs through the holes. He zipped up and watched Jonny while he put his arms in his shirtsleeves. “Hey, Jonny?—you change these sheets today, okay?” he said as he nodded to the bed.

Jonny said, “Aren’t you getting a new bed?”

He nodded, buttoning up. “Won’t come till tomorrow.”

“Okay,” Jonny agreed.

“I was you,” Reza said, slipping his feet into his shoes, “I’d be at that computer already.”

“I’ll start when you leave.”

“You wait for the conditions to be right you’re gonna wind up in trouble, kid. You let me get in your head and you’re gonna lose that hot wife of yours.”

“You’re not gonna get in my head,” he said.

Reza huffed, smiling. “You need anything?”

“Like what?”

“You got everything you need to show your wife you’re not just a dreamer? More monitors, faster computer? You know ...?”

“Monitors.”

“Yeah? Order what you want. I’ll put it on your tab.”

“How does the tab work?”

“I’ll just tack more months on the end of the term, Jonny. You want more monitors?—sixty months becomes sixty-one months, you get it?”

“You’re really getting off on this aren’t you?”

Expecting more challenge from him, more superior condescension, a volley, putting the ball back in his court, instead Reza admitted it, saying, “Yes, I am. I’m fucking getting *off* on this, Jonny. Saving me money, too. Cheaper than renting where I would *really* stay, *and* I get to fuck your wife’s tight pussy. And I don’t know what I’ll enjoy better, watching her innocent face when she comes on my cock every night or her eventual realization that she made a big, big mistake marrying you. It’s beautiful. She can love me, she can hate me, and it don’t matter,” he shrugged and smiled gleefully. “It’s all your fault I’m in her life because you’re a loser.”

Jonny said, “I’m not a loser.”

Reza laughed, tapped the blank monitor of Jonny’s custom rig and said, “Get to work, Jonny.”

AFTERWORD

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